

SERVICE DESK / INFRASTRUCTURE / OPERATIONS

General IT English

Clear language for reliable services and accountable decisions.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For service-desk staff, systems administrators, infrastructure teams, and technical coordinators.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Clarify the fault, test the explanation, and communicate the next action precisely.

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Describe the service, not just the server.

IT conversations cross technical and business boundaries. A useful message identifies the affected function, the evidence, the operational impact, and the next owner without turning a hypothesis into a confirmed cause.

Translate impact into a specific function

"The system is down" may mean that one export fails while sign-in and other tasks still work. Clarify the task before choosing the priority.

"You can sign in, but invoice export fails. Which users and periods have you checked?"

Distinguish a clue from a diagnosis

A pattern can narrow an investigation without proving its cause. Ask which test supports the proposed explanation.

"The failure occurs through the VPN; DNS remains one hypothesis, not the established cause."

Make status words operational

Downloaded, installed, restarted, verified, and complete describe different states. A status update should make the remaining work visible.

"Installation succeeded on 180 laptops; twelve are offline and eight returned errors."

Separate urgency from permission

A business deadline can justify prompt escalation but does not itself authorize unrestricted access or an unreviewed production change.

"I will expedite the reporting-role request; administrator access needs separate justification."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Fictional workplace language practice, not instructions for administering real systems or handling live incidents. Follow authorized procedures, access controls, and qualified security review. Use invented accounts and records in practice.

"The system is down" means the export fails

A Read the situation

Narrow an ambiguous incident report and agree on an evidence-based update.

Ren reports that the finance system is down. Ren can sign in and view invoices, but exporting the current month produces an error. Two colleagues report the same export problem; other users and functions have not been checked. The billing team needs its file by 3 p.m. Asha owns service-desk triage and can escalate the ticket, but cannot promise a repair time.

PEOPLE / Asha: Service-desk analyst | Ren: Billing coordinator

CLARIFICATION IS PART OF TAKING THE PROBLEM SERIOUSLY

A user may describe the whole system as down because one blocked function prevents their work. Acknowledge the business impact, then narrow the technical description without arguing about the word down.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which function is confirmed to fail?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Signing in | B Viewing every invoice |
| C Every function for every user | D Exporting the current month's invoices |

2. How many people have reported the export issue?

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------|
| A One | B Two hundred |
| C Every employee | D Three |

3. What may Asha promise?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A An escalation and a timed update | B A repair before 3 p.m. |
| C That no other function is affected | D That the billing deadline will be waived |

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service desk

The contact point coordinating user support.

IN USE contact the service desk

ticket

A recorded request or issue for tracking.

IN USE update the ticket

triage

Initial assessment of impact, priority, and ownership.

IN USE triage an incident

incident

An unplanned disruption or reduction in service.

IN USE report a service incident

service request

A request for a routine agreed service.

IN USE fulfill a service request

impact

The effect on users or business work.

IN USE assess business impact

urgency

How quickly action is needed in the circumstances.

IN USE establish the urgency

priority

The relative order or importance assigned to work.

IN USE assign a ticket priority

affected user

A person experiencing the reported problem.

IN USE identify affected users

scope

The functions, users, or locations included.

IN USE establish the incident scope

symptom

An observed sign of a problem.

IN USE record the exact symptom

error message

Text identifying or describing an error condition.

IN USE capture the error message

Precision check

Urgency concerns time pressure; impact concerns consequences and scope. Priority normally reflects an organization's agreed assessment, not just the strongest wording in a ticket. A response commitment is not a repair guarantee.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

reproduce

Make the reported behavior occur again.

IN USE reproduce the export failure

workaround

A temporary way to reduce impact without fixing the cause.

IN USE verify a workaround

resolution

Restoration or completion according to the agreed criteria.

IN USE confirm the resolution

response time

Time until support responds under a defined measure.

IN USE distinguish response time from repair time

restoration time

Time until a disrupted service is restored.

IN USE estimate restoration time cautiously

escalation

Referral for higher authority or specialist attention.

IN USE request a technical escalation

assignment group

The team designated to handle a ticket.

IN USE confirm the assignment group

service owner

The role accountable for the service.

IN USE notify the service owner

knowledge article

A maintained support reference for a known task or issue.

IN USE check the knowledge article

duplicate ticket

Another ticket reporting the same underlying incident.

IN USE link a duplicate ticket

status update

A communication of progress and remaining uncertainty.

IN USE send a timed status update

closure criterion

A condition required before work is marked closed.

IN USE agree on closure criteria

Precision check

A workaround may reduce impact while the cause remains unresolved. Closing a duplicate ticket does not close the underlying incident. State where the authoritative progress record remains available.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE IMPACT

"I understand the export is blocking your billing file."

CHECK WHAT WORKS

"Can you still view the invoices on screen?"

REQUEST EVIDENCE

"Please send the exact error text through the approved support channel."

OFFER A COMMITMENT

"I will escalate the ticket and update you by noon."

NARROW THE FUNCTION

"Which action fails after you sign in?"

ESTABLISH SCOPE

"Who else has tried the same export and seen the error?"

SEPARATE DEADLINES

"Your billing deadline is 3 p.m.; the repair time is not yet known."

READ BACK THE ISSUE

"Sign-in and viewing work; the current-month export fails for three reported users."

Can versus cannot

Paired statements such as "can sign in but cannot export" describe the boundary of failure.

So far

"Three users so far" preserves the possibility that the scope is wider.

By versus at

"By noon" sets a latest time; "at noon" names a specific time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK A WORKAROUND

"Has anyone verified that the alternative produces the required file?"

EXPLAIN ESCALATION

"I am asking the application team to investigate this function."

LINK RELATED REPORTS

"I will link the reports so the investigation has one shared record."

DEFINE CLOSURE

"We will confirm that the required export works before closing the incident."

AVOID A PROMISE

"I cannot confirm a restoration time before the technical assessment."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"Other functions and users have not yet been checked."

CONFIRM THE OWNER

"Which team is accepting the next investigation step?"

CLOSE THE UPDATE

"The next message will include findings, outstanding questions, and the next owner."

Reported versus affected

Three reported users does not prove that only three users are affected.

Will update

A promise to update names a controllable communication action, not an unverified repair outcome.

Present perfect

"Who has tried the export?" asks about attempts relevant to the current investigation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which ticket summary is most accurate?

- A** Only Ren is affected and all other functions are verified.
- B** The export has already been restored.
- C** Current-month export fails for three reported users; sign-in and viewing work for Ren.
- D** The entire finance platform is unavailable to every user.

2. Which statement promises communication rather than repair?

- A** The export will be fixed by noon.
- B** Every user will be unblocked by noon.
- C** No technical investigation will be needed.
- D** I will send a progress update by noon.

3. Which question establishes business impact?

- A** Which error code did the export return?
- B** Does the failure occur for earlier reporting periods too?
- C** Which application team owns export processing?
- D** What work cannot proceed without that file?

4. What does "three reported users" avoid claiming?

- A** That anyone has reported a fault
- B** That the issue has an impact
- C** That a ticket can be escalated
- D** That the affected population is limited to three

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

"The system is down" means the export fails

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

error message / restoration time / closure criterion / workaround / scope / symptom / escalation / assignment group / impact / duplicate ticket

- 01 **Ren:** The finance system is down, and billing needs the monthly file by three. I have already tried twice, so this is becoming urgent for us.
- 02 **Asha:** I understand the business ¹ _____. To route this correctly, can you tell me which action fails after you open the application?
- 03 **Ren:** I can sign in and see the invoices. When I choose the current month and export, I get an error instead of the file.
- 04 **Asha:** That narrows the ² _____. I will record an export failure, while keeping the billing deadline visible in the ticket.
- 05 **Ren:** Two colleagues have the same problem. We have not checked older periods or asked the other office. Does that mean it is a major outage?
- 06 **Asha:** It means three users have reported this ³ _____. I need the agreed impact assessment before assigning a broader classification, but I can escalate now.
- 07 **Ren:** Please do. Would a screenshot help? It shows invoice details, so I do not want to paste it into the general team chat.
- 08 **Asha:** Use the approved support channel and follow its handling rules. The exact ⁴ _____ and approximate time will help the application team locate the event.
- 09 **Ren:** Someone suggested copying the visible rows manually. I am worried that might omit invoices across multiple pages, and we have not checked the totals.
- 10 **Asha:** Then it is an unverified ⁵ _____, not a solution I can recommend as complete. I will ask the service owner to assess an acceptable alternative.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Ren:** Can I tell my manager the technical team will fix it before three? They are asking me for a firm answer about the billing run.
- 12 **Asha:** I cannot promise a ⁶ _____ before their assessment. I can commit to a progress update by noon, even if the cause remains unknown.
- 13 **Ren:** Noon for an update, not necessarily a fix. I'll make that clear to my manager. Please put it in the ticket too.
- 14 **Asha:** I will. I am sending a technical ⁷ _____ with the confirmed scope, the error details, and your business deadline as separate fields.
- 15 **Ren:** My colleagues each opened a ticket. Should they close theirs now, or leave them open so the team can see that this is not just me?
- 16 **Asha:** I will link them to the main record as related reports. A ⁸ _____ can be managed without suggesting that the underlying export problem is resolved.
- 17 **Ren:** Could you read that back before you send it? I don't want the team checking invoice viewing when it's the export I need.
- 18 **Asha:** Certainly. Sign-in and viewing work for you; current-month export fails for three reported users. Other functions remain unchecked. Billing needs the file by three, and the ⁹ _____ is the application support team.
- 19 **Ren:** That captures it. Please include me on the noon update. Once they say it is fixed, I can verify the export and compare the file totals.
- 20 **Asha:** I will record that as the ¹⁰ _____. We will distinguish a reported fix from your confirmation that the required task works again.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. impact | 2. scope | 3. symptom | 4. error message | 5. workaround | 6. restoration time | 7. escalation | 8. duplicate ticket | 9. assignment group | 10. closure criterion

Printing fails, but document editing still works

F Say it

A user can edit and save documents but cannot print to one office printer. Another printer has not been tested. The user needs printed copies for a 2 p.m. meeting.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

printer / restoration / update / failure

Analyst: "The confirmed ¹ _____ is printing to that device, not document editing."

User: "I have not verified an alternative ² _____ yet."

Analyst: "I will report the meeting deadline separately from the unknown ³ _____ time."

User: "Please give me a timed ⁴ _____ even if the repair is still pending."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. failure | 2. printer | 3. restoration | 4. update

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the dialogue. Read the confirmed boundary: Ren can sign in and view invoices, but current-month export fails for three reported users.

2. Switch roles. Keep the 3 p.m. billing deadline separate from the unknown repair time; repeat the noon progress-update commitment.

3. Complete the printer exchange. Preserve the untested alternative and do not promise restoration before the 2 p.m. meeting.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

A Read the situation

Challenge premature certainty and agree on comparisons that separate hypotheses.

The staff portal works from the office network but fails for four people connected through the virtual private network (VPN). The same portal address is used. Nobody has checked name resolution, routing, or access-policy logs for those requests. Eli says DNS must be the cause. Nia coordinates network investigation. The team has an approved diagnostic process and must not change production settings merely to test a guess.

PEOPLE / Eli: Support engineer | Nia: Network engineer

QUESTION THE INFERENCE, NOT THE COLLEAGUE

A confident diagnosis can spread faster than its evidence. Acknowledge the useful pattern and ask what would distinguish competing explanations. "What supports DNS over routing?" preserves the investigation without making disagreement personal.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which pattern is established?

- A** Every internet connection fails.
- B** DNS returns the wrong address.
- C** A firewall rule has been identified.
- D** Office access works; four VPN users report failure.

2. Which cause is confirmed?

- A** None of the proposed causes
- B** DNS
- C** Routing
- D** An access-policy rule

3. What constraint applies to investigation?

- A** Treat confidence as evidence.
- B** Tell users that every path is healthy.
- C** Follow the approved process without changing production on a guess.
- D** Disable production controls immediately.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

VPN

Virtual private network; a connection providing a defined private access path.

IN USE connect through the VPN

DNS

Domain Name System; the system that resolves names to records.

IN USE investigate a DNS hypothesis

name resolution

Translating a name into the records needed for a connection.

IN USE verify name resolution

IP address

A numerical network address used by the Internet Protocol.

IN USE compare resolved IP addresses

hostname

A name identifying a host or service endpoint.

IN USE confirm the hostname

resolver

A service that answers or obtains DNS responses.

IN USE identify the configured resolver

cache

Stored data reused to avoid repeating work.

IN USE inspect a cached response

TTL

Time to live; a lifetime limit, with meaning depending on context.

IN USE check a DNS record's TTL

routing

Selection of paths for network traffic.

IN USE review routing evidence

route

A path or forwarding rule for reaching a destination.

IN USE inspect the relevant route

gateway

A system providing a path between networks or services.

IN USE identify the gateway

subnet

A defined subdivision of an IP network.

IN USE compare affected subnets

Precision check

A timeout, a refused connection, and a certificate warning are different observations. "The VPN is connected" does not establish that every destination is reachable. Name the source, destination, and observed result.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

firewall

A control that permits or blocks network traffic under rules.

IN USE review firewall logs

access policy

Rules determining permitted access under stated conditions.

IN USE check the access policy

port

A numbered transport endpoint associated with a service.

IN USE identify the service port

packet loss

Failure of transmitted network packets to reach their destination.

IN USE measure packet loss

round-trip time

Time for a request and return response across a path.

IN USE compare round-trip times

timeout

Expiry of a waiting period before a response completes.

IN USE record a connection timeout

connection refusal

An explicit rejection of a connection attempt.

IN USE distinguish refusal from timeout

TLS

Transport Layer Security; protection for communication in transit.

IN USE inspect a TLS handshake error

certificate

A signed digital statement used to bind identity and a public key.

IN USE review a certificate warning

proxy

An intermediary handling requests between client and destination.

IN USE identify the proxy path

reachability

Whether a destination can be contacted under specified conditions.

IN USE test service reachability

diagnostic hypothesis

A proposed explanation that still requires testing.

IN USE test a diagnostic hypothesis

Precision check

DNS, routing, and access policy are different parts of connectivity. A working office path can narrow the comparison but does not by itself identify which VPN-path component differs. TTL has protocol-specific meanings.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE A PATTERN

"The reports do point to a difference between access paths."

STATE A HYPOTHESIS

"Name resolution is one explanation we still need to test."

DEFINE A COMPARISON

"Compare the same destination from the two approved paths."

NAME MISSING EVIDENCE

"We have not checked the resolver or policy logs for those requests."

CHALLENGE CERTAINTY

"What evidence establishes DNS rather than another path issue?"

REQUEST EXACT WORDING

"Was it a timeout, a refusal, or a certificate warning?"

PRESERVE CONTROLS

"We should not change production settings to test an unverified guess."

CLOSE THE INFERENCE

"The pattern narrows the investigation; it does not yet establish a cause."

Must versus may

"DNS must be the cause" expresses certainty; "DNS may be involved" presents a possibility.

Rather than

Use "what supports DNS rather than routing?" to compare explanations without claiming either is established.

From versus through

"From the office" identifies the source; "through the VPN" identifies a path.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE SOURCE

"Were all four reports from the same VPN profile?"

LIMIT AN OBSERVATION

"The portal worked for this office test at this time."

ASK FOR TIMESTAMPS

"Please include the time and time zone for each failed request."

REPORT A NEGATIVE RESULT

"That check did not support the DNS hypothesis."

DISTINGUISH LAYERS

"A successful name lookup does not prove application access."

AVOID A UNIVERSAL CLAIM

"We have not tested every VPN user or destination."

ASSIGN A TEST

"Who will collect the approved comparison and record the results?"

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"Keep the observed results separate from the proposed explanation."

Did not support

A negative check weakens a particular explanation without necessarily proving every alternative.

Which error

Asking for the exact error prevents different symptoms from being collapsed into one label.

At this time

Time qualifications matter because intermittent faults can change between checks.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement preserves the evidence boundary?

- A** Every network component is broken.
- B** A connected VPN guarantees portal access.
- C** The VPN path is associated with the reported failures; the cause is unconfirmed.
- D** DNS has been proven faulty because office access works.

2. Which question distinguishes the observed failure from a proposed cause?

- A** Is DNS the cause because the office path works?
- B** Did the VPN profile cause a firewall failure?
- C** Should we assume the resolver differs before checking it?
- D** Did the request time out, get refused, or show a certificate warning?

3. What does a successful name lookup establish?

- A** That no packet can be lost
- B** That this lookup returned a result under the tested conditions
- C** That the application must be reachable
- D** That the user's permissions are correct

4. Which commitment is appropriate before diagnosis?

- A** I will report the comparison results and remaining hypotheses.
- B** I will fix DNS before confirming it is involved.
- C** I will remove every access control today.
- D** I will certify all VPN traffic as healthy.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

The VPN pattern is a clue, not a DNS diagnosis

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

name resolution / diagnosis / time zone / timeout / hypothesis / reachability / comparison / access policy / symptom / hostname

- 01 **Eli:** Four VPN users cannot reach the staff portal, while the office test works. This must be DNS. I am ready to put that in the incident update.
- 02 **Nia:** The access-path pattern is useful, but DNS is still a ¹ _____. What result distinguishes name resolution from routing or an access-policy issue?
- 03 **Eli:** We do not have that result yet. The reports all use the same portal address, and everyone says the page will not open after connecting.
- 04 **Nia:** Then ask for the exact ² _____. A timeout, a refusal, and a certificate warning should not be recorded as the same observation.
- 05 **Eli:** I can collect the wording and timestamps. Does the fact that their VPN says connected tell us that the connection to the portal is available?
- 06 **Nia:** No. It confirms that connection state, not portal ³ _____. We need to follow the approved diagnostic process for the destination they actually need.
- 07 **Eli:** Someone suggested changing the resolver for all VPN users and seeing whether the complaints stop. That would be a quick way to test the theory.
- 08 **Nia:** A production change has its own approval requirements. First collect the authorized comparison of ⁴ _____ and the relevant path evidence without altering everyone else's settings.
- 09 **Eli:** Understood. I will ask whether all four people use the same VPN profile. If they do, that may help us narrow where to compare the configuration.
- 10 **Nia:** Yes, and include the source network and ⁵ _____. We want comparable requests, not a working office test against a different address.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Eli:** If the lookup gives the same address on both paths, should we remove DNS from the report completely and say it is definitely the firewall?
- 12 **Nia:** No. Record what that check establishes, then review the next evidence. A matching answer does not automatically prove an ⁶ _____ caused the failure.
- 13 **Eli:** I'll ask whether the page eventually opens or never loads. The reports just say slow, so I may have combined different problems.
- 14 **Nia:** Exactly. Record a ⁷ _____ only if that is the actual result. Do not infer it from a user saying the request took too long.
- 15 **Eli:** Who should collect the approved network checks? I can gather user reports, but I do not have permission to inspect every network device involved.
- 16 **Nia:** I will coordinate the network evidence and name the appropriate owner for each boundary. Include the ⁸ _____ so we can match the requests to the correct records.
- 17 **Eli:** I will revise the update: four reports through the VPN, one successful office test, exact errors being collected, and no verified root cause yet.
- 18 **Nia:** Good. The ⁹ _____ should show what differs and what remains unchanged. That gives the next team something concrete to investigate.
- 19 **Eli:** I'll remove the definite DNS diagnosis from the update now. Send me the comparison when it's ready and I'll add what it shows.
- 20 **Nia:** Exactly. A useful ¹⁰ _____ depends on the evidence, not on keeping the first guess. We can be decisive about the next test while remaining uncertain about the cause.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. hypothesis | 2. symptom | 3. reachability | 4. name resolution | 5. hostname | 6. access policy | 7. timeout | 8. time zone | 9. comparison | 10. diagnosis

One browser reports a certificate warning

F Say it

The same portal opens in an approved office test, while a remote user reports a certificate warning. No certificate or proxy review has occurred. The team must describe the actual warning without telling the user to bypass it.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

timestamp / warning / hypothesis / bypass

Analyst: "The reported symptom is a certificate ¹ _____, not a confirmed DNS failure."

Engineer: "Record the hostname and the ² _____ with its time zone."

Analyst: "The proxy path is another ³ _____ to investigate."

Engineer: "Follow the approved process; do not ask the user to ⁴ _____ the warning."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. warning | 2. timestamp | 3. hypothesis | 4. bypass

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the dialogue. Contrast the working office path with four reported VPN failures; keep DNS as a hypothesis, not a finding.
2. Switch roles. Request the exact warning, path and timestamp through the approved process, without proposing a speculative production change.
3. Complete the certificate exchange. Retain the unreviewed proxy hypothesis and the instruction not to bypass the warning.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A report request does not justify administrator access

A Read the situation

Clarify the required task and refuse excessive access while offering a legitimate route.

A temporary analyst, Jo, needs to download a monthly report. Jo requests administrator access because the current account shows an access-denied message. A reporting role may allow the required download, but its exact permissions have not been verified. Imani handles access requests. The manager can confirm Jo's business need; the system owner approves the role. The assignment ends on 30 November.

PEOPLE / Jo: Temporary analyst | Imani: Identity and access analyst

OFFER A ROUTE, NOT JUST A REFUSAL

A user may ask for administrator rights as a shortcut because they do not know which role fits the task. Clarify the action, explain the authority boundary, and name the narrower request and approval needed. Urgency does not establish permission.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What task does Jo need to perform?

- A Reconfigure the system
- C Download a monthly report

- B Approve other users' roles
- D Change all user accounts

2. Who approves the system role?

- A The system owner
- C Any colleague with access

- B Jo alone
- D The manager without system review

3. What remains unverified?

- A Whether Jo is temporary
- C Whether an access request exists

- B The assignment end date
- D Whether the reporting role permits the download

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

identity

The representation of a user or service in a system.

IN USE verify the account identity

authentication

Establishing that a claimant controls the required identity evidence.

IN USE complete authentication

authorization

Permission to perform an action on a resource.

IN USE check authorization

permission

An allowed action or access right.

IN USE grant a specific permission

role

A defined collection of access rights or responsibilities.

IN USE assign a reporting role

RBAC

Role-based access control; access organized through defined roles.

IN USE review an RBAC assignment

least privilege

Access limited to what is needed for the task.

IN USE apply least privilege

administrator

A role with broad system-management permissions.

IN USE justify administrator access

privileged access

Access allowing sensitive or powerful actions.

IN USE review privileged access

entitlement

A specific granted right to use a resource or capability.

IN USE review account entitlements

provisioning

Creating or assigning accounts and access.

IN USE complete approved provisioning

deprovisioning

Removing accounts or access no longer required.

IN USE schedule deprovisioning

Precision check

Authentication establishes identity evidence; authorization governs permitted actions. Being able to sign in does not imply permission to download every report. A role name alone does not prove its actual rights.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

access review

A check that granted access remains appropriate.

IN USE conduct an access review

access request

A recorded request for specified permissions.

IN USE submit a scoped access request

business justification

The work-related reason supporting a request.

IN USE document the business justification

approver

The person authorized to approve a request.

IN USE identify the correct approver

expiration

The point at which an entitlement or credential ends.

IN USE set an access expiration

temporary access

Access granted for a defined limited period.

IN USE request temporary access

separation of duties

Dividing incompatible responsibilities to reduce risk.

IN USE preserve separation of duties

SSO

Single sign-on; using one authentication session across services.

IN USE troubleshoot an SSO session

MFA

Multifactor authentication; use of distinct factor types.

IN USE complete MFA verification

service account

An identity used by an application or automated process.

IN USE identify the service-account owner

audit log

A record of relevant actions for review.

IN USE inspect the access audit log

access denied

A message indicating that an attempted action was not permitted.

IN USE report an access-denied message

Precision check

Business justification explains why access is needed. Approval establishes permission under the stated process. Temporary access needs a defined end or review condition; it should not silently become permanent.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE ACTION

"Which report do you need, and what action must you perform?"

REFUSE PROPORTIONATELY

"I cannot justify administrator rights from the stated reporting task."

NAME THE APPROVER

"Your manager confirms the need; the system owner approves the role."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The role may fit, but its permissions still need checking."

SEPARATE IDENTITY AND ACCESS

"You can sign in; the download permission is a different question."

OFFER A NARROWER ROUTE

"Let us verify whether the reporting role covers that download."

LIMIT DURATION

"The requested access should match the assignment ending on 30 November."

CONFIRM THE REQUEST

"I will submit the task, resource, duration, and approval route together."

May versus does

"The role may allow download" signals an unverified fit; "the role allows download" claims a confirmed permission.

Need to versus need rights to

Ask for the required task before adopting the user's proposed permission level.

Not yet granted

This states pending authorization without implying permanent refusal.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID CREDENTIAL SHARING

"Please use your own approved account rather than another person's credentials."

EXPLAIN LEAST PRIVILEGE

"The request should provide the required action without unrelated control."

CHECK COMPLETION

"After provisioning, confirm the authorized report action works."

DISTINGUISH ROLES

"A reporting role and an administrator role serve different purposes."

CHECK EXISTING RIGHTS

"Which entitlement is currently assigned to your account?"

HANDLE URGENCY

"I can flag the deadline without bypassing the approval process."

RECORD AN END

"Who will verify removal when the assignment finishes?"

CLOSE CLEARLY

"Approval is pending; the request has been submitted, not granted."

Until

"Until 30 November" sets an end boundary; specify local handling of the date in the real request.

Can versus authorized to

Technical capability is not the same as organizational permission.

Role of because

Give the concrete reason: "Administrator access is broader than this task requires."

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which request is best scoped?

- A** Permanent administrator access to all systems
- B** Permission to use a colleague's account
- C** Access to every financial record because one export fails
- D** Access to download the named monthly report for the assignment period

2. Which statement distinguishes authentication from authorization?

- A** MFA approval replaces system-owner approval.
- B** Signing in does not prove permission to download the report.
- C** Signing in grants every application permission.
- D** A role name proves every entitlement.

3. Who should confirm business need in this case?

- A** The system owner instead of the stated manager
- B** Imani by treating ticket submission as business approval
- C** A colleague who already has the reporting role
- D** Jo's manager

4. Which status is accurate before approval?

- A** Permanent because no removal date was discussed.
- B** Submitted for review; access has not been granted.
- C** Approved because the request is urgent.
- D** Provisioned because the manager received the message.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A report request does not justify administrator access

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approver / credentials / entitlements / least privilege / deprovisioning / Authentication / permission / provisioning / business justification / expiration

- 01 **Jo:** I need administrator access to finish the monthly reporting work. I can sign in, but the download gives me an access-denied message every time.
- 02 **Imani:** Let us identify the required ¹ _____ first. Which report are you downloading, and do you need to change anything in the system?
- 03 **Jo:** It is the monthly sales summary. I only need to download it and analyze the file. I am not changing accounts or system settings.
- 04 **Imani:** Then administrator rights would be broader than that ² _____. There may be a reporting role that provides the specific action.
- 05 **Jo:** I assumed signing in meant I already had access and the download error was just a technical fault. Are those separate parts of the process?
- 06 **Imani:** Yes. ³ _____ gets you through the identity check. Authorization determines which resources and actions the account is allowed to use afterward.
- 07 **Jo:** Could you assign the reporting role now and let me check whether it works? My manager needs the analysis, and I am only here temporarily.
- 08 **Imani:** The system owner must approve it first. I also need to verify its actual ⁴ _____, because the role name alone does not confirm that download is included.
- 09 **Jo:** My manager can confirm the work is required. Does that approval cover the role too, or does the system owner need a separate request?
- 10 **Imani:** In this process they have different responsibilities. The manager confirms the need, and the system owner is the ⁵ _____ for the system role.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Jo:** That is clear. The assignment ends on 30 November. I do not expect to need the system afterward unless the contract is formally extended.
- 12 **Imani:** I will include an ⁶ _____ aligned with that assignment and the required review route if it changes.
- 13 **Jo:** While we wait, a colleague offered to download the file using their account. Is that the same as sharing their password so I can do it myself?
- 14 **Imani:** Those are different proposals, and neither should bypass the approved process. Do not share ⁷ _____. Ask the report owner whether an authorized delivery route is permitted.
- 15 **Jo:** I'll ask the report owner. In the meantime, can you flag the deadline and get the role review moving?
- 16 **Imani:** Exactly. We can expedite review while preserving ⁸ _____. I will submit the report name, required action, duration, and business justification together.
- 17 **Jo:** Will the approval email mean I can download immediately, or is there another step after that?
- 18 **Imani:** Approval and ⁹ _____ are separate states. After the role is assigned, confirm that the authorized download works with your own account.
- 19 **Jo:** And at the end of November, the access should be removed unless an extension is reviewed. Please include who checks that so it is not forgotten.
- 20 **Imani:** I will record ¹⁰ _____ ownership. For now the status is submitted for review, not granted, and we have a legitimate route that matches the work you actually need to do.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. permission | 2. business justification | 3. Authentication | 4. entitlements | 5. approver | 6. expiration | 7. credentials | 8. least privilege | 9. provisioning | 10. deprovisioning

A contractor needs read-only dashboard access

F Say it

A contractor needs to view one project dashboard for two weeks, not edit it. The project manager confirms the need; the dashboard owner approves access. No approval has yet been recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval / pending / duration / viewing

Analyst: "The requested action is ¹ _____, not editing or administration."

Manager: "I can confirm the business need, but the owner provides ² _____."

Analyst: "The request will include a two-week ³ _____."

Manager: "Until review is complete, describe the access as ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. viewing | 2. approval | 3. duration | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers. Read the required monthly-report action, assignment ending 30 November, and unverified fit of the reporting role.
2. Switch roles. Distinguish the manager's confirmation of need from the system owner's approval; do not substitute administrator rights for the scoped request.
3. Complete the dashboard exchange. Retain viewing-only access for two weeks and pending approval.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

A Read the situation

Compare incomplete estimates and qualify a recommendation without inventing missing costs.

Two monthly cloud planning estimates cover the same application. Option A is \$800 and excludes backup storage. Option B is \$1,050 and includes backup storage. Transfer charges and support coverage have not been confirmed for either option. Jordan prepares the comparison; Sal owns infrastructure planning. These are fictional estimates, not provider prices. No purchasing decision has been approved.

PEOPLE / Jordan: Cloud operations analyst | Sal: Infrastructure planning lead

COMPARABLE TOTALS REQUIRE COMPARABLE SCOPE

A low headline figure can be accurate yet unsuitable for a decision when inclusions differ. Identify missing line items without accusing the estimator of deception. Ask for a like-for-like comparison and keep unknown amounts unknown.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which cost difference is confirmed?

- A Both quotes cover identical items.
- B Only Option B includes backup storage.
- C Option A includes all support.
- D Transfer charges are zero for both.

2. What is the headline difference?

- A No difference
- B \$250 per month
- C \$1,850 per month
- D \$800 per year

3. Which conclusion is premature?

- A Option A omits backup storage.
- B No purchase is approved.
- C Option A is the cheaper complete solution.
- D Option B's estimate is \$1,050.

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

cloud service

Computing capability delivered through a service model.

IN USE compare cloud services

infrastructure

The underlying computing and network resources.

IN USE plan infrastructure capacity

instance

A running or configured unit of computing capacity.

IN USE size a compute instance

virtual machine

A software-defined computing environment emulating a machine.

IN USE provision a virtual machine

region

A provider-defined geographical deployment area.

IN USE choose an approved region

availability zone

A provider-defined location grouping within a region.

IN USE compare availability-zone designs

object storage

Storage that manages data as objects with metadata.

IN USE estimate object-storage usage

block storage

Storage presented as addressable blocks.

IN USE size block-storage volumes

snapshot

A point-in-time representation of data or system state.

IN USE document a snapshot policy

backup

A retained copy intended to support recovery.

IN USE include backup storage

retention period

The length of time data is kept.

IN USE confirm the retention period

restore test

A check that retained data can be recovered as required.

IN USE schedule a restore test

Precision check

The \$250 difference compares two headline estimates with different inclusions. It is not a verified saving for equivalent services. RPO describes a data-loss interval; RTO describes a restoration-time target.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

RPO

Recovery point objective; tolerated data-loss interval.

IN USE agree on the RPO

RTO

Recovery time objective; target time to restore service.

IN USE agree on the RTO

egress

Data leaving a defined network or service boundary.

IN USE estimate egress charges

ingress

Data entering a defined network or service boundary.

IN USE identify ingress traffic

consumption

Measured resource use over a period.

IN USE forecast resource consumption

reservation

A commitment or capacity allocation under stated terms.

IN USE compare reservation terms

on-demand

Resource use without the particular advance commitment being discussed.

IN USE estimate on-demand usage

right-sizing

Matching resource allocation to workload needs.

IN USE assess right-sizing options

cost allocation

Assignment of expenses to services or owners.

IN USE document cost allocation

line item

An individual entry in an estimate or bill.

IN USE compare each line item

exclusion

A cost or service left outside the stated scope.

IN USE disclose estimate exclusions

total cost

Combined cost under explicitly defined inclusions.

IN USE compare like-for-like total cost

Precision check

A snapshot or stored backup does not prove that recovery has been tested. Provider pricing, region terminology, and commitment conditions vary; these fictional amounts teach comparison language, not purchasing advice.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE MISMATCH

"The estimates do not include the same services."

LIMIT THE ARITHMETIC

"The headline difference is \$250, not a confirmed like-for-like saving."

KEEP UNCERTAINTY VISIBLE

"Transfer charges remain unconfirmed for both options."

SEPARATE COST AND RECOVERY

"Including storage does not establish that restoration has been tested."

STATE THE KNOWN DIFFERENCE

"Option A excludes backup storage; Option B includes it."

REQUEST A COMMON BASIS

"Can we compare both options against the same workload and retention assumptions?"

ASK ABOUT COVERAGE

"Does support cover the hours and response level we need?"

BOUND THE RECOMMENDATION

"I cannot recommend the lower total until the missing items are priced."

Includes versus costs

A quoted amount and its included services must be reported together.

Unknown versus zero

"Not confirmed" is missing information, not a numerical zero.

Per

State the billing unit explicitly: per month, per gigabyte, or per request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK A UNIT

"Is that per month, per stored unit, or per transfer volume?"

ASK ABOUT COMMITMENTS

"What term or minimum spend is attached to that figure?"

AVOID INVENTED NUMBERS

"I will mark the amount unknown rather than enter zero."

COMPARE SENSITIVITY

"Show how the estimate changes under the agreed higher-use scenario."

EXPOSE AN ASSUMPTION

"Which usage pattern does this estimate assume?"

PRESERVE EXCLUSIONS

"Put the excluded items next to the headline total."

CLARIFY AN OBJECTIVE

"Is that the tolerated data-loss interval or the restoration-time target?"

CLOSE THE COMPARISON

"We will reconcile the scope before asking for a purchasing decision."

Would save

Conditional savings depend on the assumptions; name those assumptions before using would save.

Same as

"The same retention period as Option B" creates a precise comparison condition.

Not until

"Not until exclusions are priced" sets a clear prerequisite for the recommendation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is defensible now?

- A** A is \$250 lower before its missing backup and other unconfirmed costs are resolved.
- B** A saves exactly \$250 for equivalent coverage.
- C** B costs \$250 more solely because its service is better.
- D** Transfer costs are included because no amount is shown.

2. How should an unconfirmed transfer charge appear?

- A** Zero, because nobody has quoted it
- B** Included, because cloud services usually bundle everything
- C** Irrelevant, because the headline is monthly
- D** Unknown, with the required assumption identified

3. Which question concerns RPO?

- A** How long must retained backup copies be kept?
- B** How many gigabytes does the backup repository hold?
- C** How far back may the recovered data point be relative to the disruption?
- D** How quickly must the service be restored?

4. What does included backup storage fail to establish?

- A** That storage is in the quoted scope
- B** That the quote contains a backup line
- C** That the estimate is monthly
- D** That a successful restore has been tested

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The cheaper estimate leaves out backup storage

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

commitment / inclusions / like-for-like / retention period / line item / consumption / audit trail / RPO / headline difference / unknown

- 01 **Jordan:** Option A is \$800 a month and Option B is \$1,050. I was going to recommend A as a \$250 monthly saving for the application.
- 02 **Sal:** Before recommending it, compare the ¹ _____. I see backup storage in B, but not in A. Are they priced on the same basis?
- 03 **Jordan:** Not yet. A's estimate explicitly excludes backup storage. I also have not confirmed transfer charges or support coverage for either option, so the comparison is incomplete.
- 04 **Sal:** Then \$250 is the ² _____, not an established saving. We should keep the arithmetic but qualify what it means.
- 05 **Jordan:** I will request the missing backup amount. Should I put zero against transfer charges until the provider confirms them, so the spreadsheet totals correctly?
- 06 **Sal:** No. Mark them ³ _____ and record the assumed traffic. A working formula should not turn an unanswered pricing question into a free service.
- 07 **Jordan:** Understood. The workload estimate also assumes the current data volume. We expect growth, but the higher-use scenario has not been agreed with the application owner.
- 08 **Sal:** Obtain that assumption before adjusting the figure. Compare ⁴ _____ on the same basis for both options rather than quietly giving one a smaller workload.
- 09 **Jordan:** For backups, is matching the storage amount enough? B includes a line for retained copies, but I have not seen evidence of a restore test.
- 10 **Sal:** Storage and recoverability are different. Ask about the agreed ⁵ _____, recovery requirements, and the process for checking restoration under the approved plan.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Jordan:** The application owner mentioned an RPO and an RTO. I want to make sure I ask the right question rather than using those labels interchangeably.
- 12 **Sal:** The ⁶ _____ concerns how much recent data loss is tolerable. RTO concerns the target restoration time. Confirm both with the authorized owner.
- 13 **Jordan:** I will also check whether either price assumes a long commitment. A may be an on-demand estimate, while B may rely on an advance reservation.
- 14 **Sal:** Exactly. Any ⁷ _____ belongs beside the monthly figure. A lower unit rate can involve obligations that change the decision.
- 15 **Jordan:** What about support? The summary says support available, but it does not specify coverage hours or which incidents receive the quoted response level.
- 16 **Sal:** Treat that as another ⁸ _____ needing clarification. Availability is not the same as included coverage that meets this application's needs.
- 17 **Jordan:** I'll hold the recommendation. For today's note, I'll show the two prices and the missing items, with provisional above the totals.
- 18 **Sal:** Yes. We are aiming for ⁹ _____ totals and clearly stated differences. We do not need to pretend the two options are identical if meaningful differences remain.
- 19 **Jordan:** I'll put the inclusions and unresolved amounts in one table. Can we review it again when the provider answers the backup and support questions?
- 20 **Sal:** Good. That creates an ¹⁰ _____ for the recommendation. We can explain what changed when the final numbers arrive instead of defending a saving we never actually verified.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. inclusions | 2. headline difference | 3. unknown | 4. consumption | 5. retention period | 6. RPO | 7. commitment | 8. line item | 9. like-for-like | 10. audit trail

An annual software quote excludes migration

F Say it

Quote A is \$12,000 annually without migration support. Quote B is \$14,000 with migration support. The required migration scope and any additional charges remain unconfirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

exclusion / unknown / like-for-like / scope

Analyst: "The \$2,000 difference compares unequal ¹ _____."

Manager: "List migration as an ² _____ from A, not an assumed free service."

Analyst: "I will keep the additional amount marked ³ _____ until it is confirmed."

Manager: "Then request a ⁴ _____ comparison before recommending a purchase."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. scope | 2. exclusion | 3. unknown | 4. like-for-like

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the dialogue. Read \$800 and \$1,050 as unequal-scope estimates: \$250 is their headline difference, not verified savings.
2. Switch roles. Ask for missing backup, transfer and support terms; keep unknown charges distinct from zero.
3. Complete the annual-quote exchange. Identify the migration exclusion before requesting a like-for-like \$12,000 versus \$14,000 comparison.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Ninety percent installed is not complete

A Read the situation

Report deployment states accurately and define evidence needed for completion.

A patch was assigned to 200 managed laptops. The console reports successful installation on 180, twelve laptops were offline, and eight returned installation errors. Post-installation verification has not been completed on all successful devices. Arun manages endpoints; Casey coordinates the rollout. A manager asks whether the deployment is complete. There is no approved exception for the remaining twenty laptops.

PEOPLE / Arun: Endpoint administrator | Casey: Rollout coordinator

USE STATE LABELS THAT PRESERVE REMAINING WORK

A broad word such as done can hide devices that were offline, failed, or still require verification. Report mutually understandable states and counts. Do not describe a percentage as completion unless the agreed criteria actually permit it.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many laptops report successful installation?

A 188

B 180

C 200

D 192

2. What is known about the remaining twenty?

A All twenty were removed from the inventory.

B Twelve were offline and eight returned errors.

C All twenty are approved exceptions.

D All twenty passed verification.

3. Why is complete premature?

A Every installation has failed.

B The console cannot show counts.

C Not all devices are installed and verified under the stated criteria.

D The patch has not been assigned to any device.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

endpoint

A user device or other terminal system on a network.

IN USE manage an endpoint

managed device

A device enrolled under an organization's management controls.

IN USE verify the managed-device inventory

asset inventory

A record of devices and their relevant attributes.

IN USE reconcile the asset inventory

patch

A software update intended to correct or change behavior.

IN USE deploy an approved patch

patch level

The installed state of relevant software updates.

IN USE confirm the patch level

deployment

Distribution and application of a configuration or update.

IN USE track deployment progress

installation

Placement and setup of software on a system.

IN USE confirm installation status

verification

Checking evidence that the required state has been achieved.

IN USE complete post-installation verification

reboot

Restarting a system.

IN USE identify a pending reboot

maintenance window

An approved period for planned service work.

IN USE schedule a maintenance window

offline

Not currently connected or available to the management system.

IN USE identify offline devices

retry

Another attempt after an earlier incomplete or failed action.

IN USE schedule an authorized retry

Precision check

Assigned, downloaded, installed, restarted, and verified are not synonyms. A successful installation report may still require a restart or verification under the approved procedure. Report the actual evidence, not the most optimistic label.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

error code

A code identifying a reported error condition.

IN USE group installation error codes

compliance state

A device's status against defined requirements.

IN USE report the compliance state

configuration baseline

The agreed reference configuration.

IN USE compare with the configuration baseline

configuration drift

Difference from the expected configuration over time.

IN USE detect configuration drift

exception

An approved departure from a requirement under stated conditions.

IN USE document an approved exception

remediation

Work to correct a deficiency or failure.

IN USE assign remediation ownership

deployment ring

A defined group receiving a staged rollout.

IN USE review a deployment ring

pilot group

A limited group used to test a change before expansion.

IN USE validate the pilot group

supersedence

Replacement of an earlier update by another.

IN USE check patch supersedence

dependency

A prerequisite needed for another action to succeed.

IN USE verify installation dependencies

rollback

Return to an earlier configuration or version.

IN USE confirm rollback readiness

completion criterion

A condition defining when work counts as complete.

IN USE state the completion criterion

Precision check

An offline device is not automatically an installation failure or an approved exception. An exception requires an authorized decision. Keep the inventory denominator stable unless an approved scope change is recorded.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REPORT THE COUNTS

"Installation succeeded on 180 of 200 managed laptops."

QUALIFY COMPLETION

"Verification is not yet complete on all reported successes."

PRESERVE THE DENOMINATOR

"The planned scope remains 200 devices unless a change is approved."

ASK FOR ERROR EVIDENCE

"Which error codes are shared across the eight failures?"

SEPARATE REMAINING STATES

"Twelve were offline; eight returned installation errors."

REJECT AN OVERSTATEMENT

"I would report progress, not mark the deployment complete."

DISTINGUISH AN EXCEPTION

"Offline status is not an approved exception."

SET THE NEXT ACTION

"Assign owners for the offline follow-up, errors, and verification."

Of versus remaining

"180 of 200" reports success against scope; "20 remaining" identifies unresolved work.

Reported versus verified

"Reports successful installation" describes a console state; "verified" names a completed check.

Yet

"Not yet complete" preserves unfinished work without predicting when it will finish.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK A RESTART

"Does the required state depend on a pending reboot?"

NAME THE CRITERION

"What evidence must every in-scope device provide for completion?"

CLARIFY A RETRY

"A retry is scheduled; its outcome is not yet known."

TRACK RECOVERY

"Keep the approved rollback route available during the rollout."

AVOID A FALSE CATEGORY

"Keep installation failure separate from devices we could not reach."

LIMIT THE PERCENTAGE

"Ninety percent installed does not mean the full rollout is verified."

RECORD A CHANGE

"Any removal from scope needs a documented reason and approval."

CLOSE HONESTLY

"The next update will show verified devices and each unresolved group."

Separate nouns

Use offline devices and failed installations as separate categories when the evidence distinguishes them.

Unless

"The scope remains 200 unless changed by approval" states the condition for revising the denominator.

Scheduled versus completed

A scheduled retry is a plan, not evidence of a successful installation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which status statement is accurate?

- A** 180 installed; twelve offline; eight errors; verification still in progress.
- B** Deployment complete because 90 percent installed.
- C** All twenty unresolved devices are approved exceptions.
- D** All 200 devices have failed verification.

2. What percentage reports successful installation?

- A** 10 percent
- B** 94 percent
- C** 96 percent
- D** 90 percent

3. Which action would distort the report?

- A** Recording verification as pending
- B** Naming an owner for follow-up
- C** Removing offline devices from scope without an approved change
- D** Listing the error group separately

4. Which statement describes a plan rather than a result?

- A** No exception has been approved.
- B** A retry is scheduled for the eight errors.
- C** The console records 180 successes.
- D** Twelve devices were offline.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Ninety percent installed is not complete

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

installation / reboot / inventory / completion criterion / criteria / remediation / denominator / offline / error codes / exception

- 01 **Casey:** The manager wants to know whether the laptop deployment is complete. The console shows 180 successes out of 200. Can I mark the rollout done?
- 02 **Arun:** Not yet. We need to distinguish ¹ _____ from verification. Twelve devices were offline and eight returned errors, so twenty still lack successful installation reports.
- 03 **Casey:** I could say ninety percent complete and list the remaining devices underneath. Would that be clearer than calling the whole deployment finished for the manager?
- 04 **Arun:** Say ninety percent report installed. Our ² _____ also includes verification, and that check has not finished on every reported success.
- 05 **Casey:** What should we call the twelve offline laptops? They may simply belong to people who were away. I do not want to count them as failed installations.
- 06 **Arun:** Keep them in an ³ _____ group. They remain in scope, but their status differs from the eight devices that actually returned installation errors.
- 07 **Casey:** Someone suggested excluding the offline devices from the total for now. That would make the progress figure look closer to the target while we contact their owners.
- 08 **Arun:** The ⁴ _____ remains 200 unless an approved scope change says otherwise. Being inconvenient to reach is not a reason to remove a device from the report.
- 09 **Casey:** Understood. For the eight errors, do we have enough information to promise a successful retry today, or do we need a separate technical review first?
- 10 **Arun:** Review the ⁵ _____ first. A shared count can hide different causes, and a scheduled retry is not evidence that the installation will complete.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Casey:** I will ask for owners and next actions for both groups. What about the successful devices that still need a restart before their new state takes effect?
- 12 **Arun:** Record any pending ⁶ _____ separately under the approved process. We should not describe a device as verified while a required state transition remains unfinished.
- 13 **Casey:** If a laptop cannot be updated during this window because of a documented application dependency, can the team mark it as an exception in the report?
- 14 **Arun:** Only after the authorized ⁷ _____ decision. Record the reason, owner, and review condition; do not convert an unresolved error into an approved departure automatically.
- 15 **Casey:** I'll show those states separately. But can a device be both installed and pending verification? I don't want the totals to exceed two hundred.
- 16 **Arun:** Yes. Pending verification can be a subset of the installed group, not extra devices to add to it. Reconcile the ⁸ _____ and state which counts overlap.
- 17 **Casey:** Can you send the verified count before this afternoon's review, with an owner for each outstanding group? That's what the manager will ask for.
- 18 **Arun:** Yes. I will include the current evidence and ⁹ _____ status. Where an action depends on a user or another team, I will make that dependency visible.
- 19 **Casey:** Then my message will say installation is progressing, twenty devices lack success reports, verification remains open, and no exception has been approved for those twenty.
- 20 **Arun:** That is accurate. We will close the rollout only when the agreed ¹⁰ _____ are met or an authorized scope decision changes them. Clear state labels let the manager decide without being misled by done.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. installation | 2. completion criterion | 3. offline | 4. denominator | 5. error codes | 6. reboot | 7. exception | 8. inventory | 9. remediation | 10. criteria

A server update is installed but not verified

F Say it

An approved server update reports successful installation. A required restart is pending, and the service check has not run. The maintenance owner must receive an accurate status.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

verification / complete / criteria / reboot

Engineer: "Installation is reported successful, but a ¹ _____ is still pending."

Owner: "Then the service check is still part of ² _____."

Engineer: "I will describe the update as in progress, not ³ _____."

Owner: "Keep the approved recovery route available until the ⁴ _____ are met."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. reboot | 2. verification | 3. complete | 4. criteria

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers. Read 180 installed, twelve offline and eight errors out of 200; distinguish the 90-percent installation rate from completion.

2. Switch roles. Treat pending verification as a possible subset of installed devices, not extra inventory; retain the approved 200-device scope.

3. Complete the server exchange. Keep the required restart and service check pending instead of reporting the update complete.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

A Read the situation

Escalate a security observation with urgency, accurate scope, and controlled evidence.

06

An alert flags an unusual sign-in for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. The account owner has not confirmed whether the activity was legitimate. No data-access review has occurred. Bea detected the alert; Tomas coordinates the authorized response team. The team has a restricted evidence channel and an on-call contact. Only authorized responders decide containment actions in this fictional organization.

PEOPLE / Bea: Security monitoring analyst | Tomas: Incident response coordinator

URGENCY AND UNCERTAINTY CAN COEXIST

You can escalate promptly without labeling an unverified event a breach. State the alert, known facts, unanswered questions, and available evidence. An appropriately qualified report helps responders act; qualification is not a reason to delay notification.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is confirmed?

- A** An unusual-sign-in alert occurred at 09:12 UTC.
- B** The account is compromised.
- C** Customer data was stolen.
- D** The account owner approved the activity.

2. Who decides containment under this case's process?

- A** The account owner without review
- B** Authorized responders
- C** Any message recipient
- D** The alert's wording alone

3. Where should detailed evidence be placed?

- A** A personal mailbox so it is separate from the affected system
- B** Any shared folder once the account name is removed
- C** The approved restricted evidence channel
- D** A broad project chat because no breach is confirmed yet

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

alert

A signal that a condition may require attention.

IN USE triage an alert

event

An observed occurrence in a system.

IN USE correlate security events

indicator

A piece of information that may point to relevant activity.

IN USE assess an indicator

compromise

Unauthorized access or loss of a system's trusted state.

IN USE investigate suspected compromise

breach

A security or privacy violation whose exact meaning depends on context.

IN USE avoid an unverified breach claim

false positive

An alert or finding that identifies a condition not actually present.

IN USE investigate a possible false positive

sign-in log

A record of authentication attempts or sessions.

IN USE preserve the sign-in log

session

A period or context of authenticated interaction.

IN USE review the account session

geolocation

An estimate of geographical position from available signals.

IN USE qualify a geolocation estimate

anomaly

A departure from an expected pattern.

IN USE assess a sign-in anomaly

SOC

Security operations center; a function coordinating monitoring and response.

IN USE notify the SOC

on-call

Assigned availability to respond during a defined period.

IN USE contact the on-call responder

Precision check

An alert is a signal to assess, not automatic proof of compromise. A location estimate is not proof of a person's physical location. Preserve the difference between observed evidence, an interpretation, and an authorized classification.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

escalation threshold

A condition requiring referral or higher attention.

IN USE apply the escalation threshold

containment

Actions intended to limit an incident's consequences.

IN USE assign containment authority

eradication

Removal of identified causes or malicious elements under a response process.

IN USE distinguish eradication from containment

recovery

Restoration of services or operations after disruption.

IN USE coordinate recovery communication

evidence preservation

Keeping relevant records intact for authorized review.

IN USE follow evidence-preservation requirements

chain of custody

A record of evidence handling and transfers.

IN USE maintain chain of custody

timeline

An ordered account of events with times.

IN USE build an incident timeline

scope assessment

Determination of affected assets, accounts, or data.

IN USE conduct a scope assessment

severity

The assessed seriousness of an incident or finding.

IN USE review incident severity

notification

Communication to designated recipients under defined rules.

IN USE confirm notification ownership

need to know

A principle restricting information to necessary recipients.

IN USE share on a need-to-know basis

post-incident review

Examination of an incident and lessons after response.

IN USE schedule a post-incident review

Precision check

Containment limits consequences; eradication addresses identified causes or malicious elements; recovery restores operations. These labels describe distinct concerns, not a universal sequence that replaces local response procedures.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LEAD WITH THE EVENT

"An unusual-sign-in alert was recorded at 09:12 UTC."

ESCALATE PROMPTLY

"I am referring this through the approved response channel now."

PROTECT THE RECORD

"The complete evidence is in the restricted channel."

PRESERVE TIMING

"Keep the original timestamp and its time zone in the timeline."

STATE THE UNKNOWN

"The account owner has not yet confirmed the activity."

AVOID A PREMATURE LABEL

"We have not established compromise or data exposure."

NAME THE AUTHORITY

"The authorized responder will decide containment actions."

SET THE NEXT UPDATE

"The next update will distinguish confirmed findings from open questions."

06

Suspected versus confirmed

These modifiers mark different evidence states and must survive shortened updates.

Has not yet

This describes an unfinished confirmation, not proof that the activity was unauthorized.

Who owns

Ask for a named responsibility rather than assuming that everyone on a message is acting.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

QUALIFY LOCATION

"The alert reports a location estimate, not verified physical travel."

LIMIT DISTRIBUTION

"Share account details only with the designated recipients."

RECORD A HANDOFF

"Please confirm who has accepted response ownership."

PRESERVE EVIDENCE

"Follow the approved handling process before altering relevant records."

CHECK SCOPE

"Which accounts and assets have actually been reviewed?"

AVOID REASSURANCE WITHOUT EVIDENCE

"An unconfirmed alert is not the same as a cleared alert."

SEPARATE DECISIONS

"Technical response and external notification have different owners."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The finding remains under review; no final classification has been made."

06

According to

"According to the alert" attributes a reported signal without treating it as verified reality.

Scope of no

"No review has occurred" describes missing investigation, not absence of data access.

Urgent but qualified

A direct escalation can include "unconfirmed" without weakening the instruction to review promptly.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which initial report is accurate?

- A** Confirmed account takeover with stolen customer data.
- B** False positive because nobody has confirmed it.
- C** Incident closed because an alert is not proof.
- D** Unusual-sign-in alert at 09:12 UTC; owner confirmation and scope review pending.

2. What does "owner confirmation pending" establish?

- A** The account was definitely stolen.
- B** Confirmation has not been completed.
- C** The owner denies the activity.
- D** The owner approves the activity.

3. Which question clarifies response ownership?

- A** Who received the alert first?
- B** Who forwarded the broadest status update?
- C** Who has technical access, even if no response role is assigned?
- D** Who has accepted responsibility for the containment decision under the approved process?

4. Which statement overclaims scope?

- A** The data-access review has not occurred.
- B** A restricted evidence channel is available.
- C** Every account is affected because one alert fired.
- D** One account generated the recorded alert.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

An unusual sign-in is not yet a confirmed compromise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

geolocation / scope assessment / under review / notification / restricted channel / alert / need-to-know / classification / timeline / containment

- 01 **Bea:** An unusual-sign-in alert fired for a staff account at 09:12 UTC. I have the event record, but the account owner has not confirmed the activity yet.
- 02 **Tomas:** Please escalate through the approved route and place the full record in the ¹ _____. We need prompt review without sending account details to everyone in the project chat.
- 03 **Bea:** Should the subject say confirmed compromise so the on-call responder treats it urgently? I do not want a qualified title to make this seem unimportant.
- 04 **Tomas:** Use suspected activity and the confirmed ² _____ details. Urgency does not require an unsupported conclusion. The escalation route communicates the need for attention.
- 05 **Bea:** The alert includes a location estimate that differs from the user's usual pattern. I have not checked whether travel or another legitimate explanation could account for it.
- 06 **Tomas:** Keep that ³ _____ limitation explicit. Do not report physical travel as fact, and do not dismiss the event merely because a benign explanation is possible.
- 07 **Bea:** I also have not reviewed subsequent data access. I will leave impact unknown rather than saying no data was accessed just because that field is empty.
- 08 **Tomas:** Correct. Missing review is not a negative finding. The responder needs a ⁴ _____ before making claims about affected data or other accounts.
- 09 **Bea:** Who decides whether any containment action is needed? I can preserve the alert, but I am not authorized to make changes to the account in this process.
- 10 **Tomas:** The authorized response team owns ⁵ _____. I will confirm the named responder has accepted the handoff rather than assume that receiving a message means someone is acting.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Bea:** I will preserve the original record and use a redacted summary for the wider operational update. The timestamp will remain 09:12 UTC in both places.
- 12 **Tomas:** Good. Consistent timing supports the ⁶ _____. Follow the evidence-handling process so the original information remains available and its history is clear.
- 13 **Bea:** If the owner later says the activity was theirs, can I close the alert immediately, or does the response team need to review that confirmation first?
- 14 **Tomas:** Follow the assigned review route. Confirmation is evidence, but the authorized reviewer decides the ⁷ _____ using the whole record and the organization's criteria.
- 15 **Bea:** Understood. The business lead is already asking whether we must notify customers. I do not have enough information to answer that, and no data review is complete.
- 16 **Tomas:** Refer ⁸ _____ decisions to the designated owner. Do not invent a legal threshold, promise no notification, or make a public statement from this initial signal.
- 17 **Bea:** I'll send the business lead a short status update: who has the case, which checks are running, and what we still don't know. No account details.
- 18 **Tomas:** Exactly. Use a ⁹ _____ summary for the audience. Clear communication does not mean every recipient receives every piece of evidence.
- 19 **Bea:** I'll submit it now. If the on-call responder hasn't accepted it, I'll follow the escalation route rather than leave it in the queue.
- 20 **Tomas:** That is the right distinction. Keep the finding ¹⁰ _____ until the authorized decision is recorded, and preserve the evidence and uncertainty in every shortened update.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. restricted channel | 2. alert | 3. geolocation | 4. scope assessment | 5. containment | 6. timeline | 7. classification | 8. notification | 9. need-to-know | 10. under review

A suspicious email is reported but not analyzed

F Say it

An employee reports a suspicious email. The attachment has not been analyzed, and no interaction has been confirmed. The approved reporting route accepts the original message for authorized review.

06

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

confirmed / unknown / know / route

Analyst: "The email is reported suspicious; malicious content is not yet

¹ _____."

Coordinator: "Use the approved reporting ² _____ for the original message."

Analyst: "Whether anyone interacted with it remains ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Keep the wider update limited to the audience's need to

⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. confirmed | 2. route | 3. unknown | 4. know

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the dialogue. Read the 09:12 UTC alert without claiming confirmed compromise or a cleared false positive.
2. Switch roles. Preserve pending account-owner confirmation and data-access review; use the restricted evidence route.
3. Complete the email exchange. Keep attachment content and user interaction unconfirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

A Read the situation

Replace an inaccurate notice, acknowledge impact, and confirm the controlling record.

A maintenance notice sent to users says Tuesday from 8 to 9 p.m. The approved change record says Thursday from 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time. The work has not begun. One team moved its export schedule in response to the incorrect notice. Mina sent the notice; Owen owns change coordination. A correction must reach the original recipients and clearly replace the earlier message.

PEOPLE / Mina: Service communications analyst | Owen: Change coordinator

A CORRECTION NEEDS AN EXPLICIT REPLACEMENT

Sending another message without identifying the error can leave two apparent sources of truth. Acknowledge the mistake, state the approved details, say which message is replaced, and address consequences already caused. Avoid implying that the authorized schedule changed when only the notice was wrong.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which window is approved?

- A** Tuesday, 8 to 9 a.m.
- B** Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time
- C** Tuesday, 8 to 9 p.m.
- D** Thursday, all day

2. What actually changed?

- A** The work moved from an approved Tuesday window.
- B** The maintenance already happened.
- C** All user exports were canceled.
- D** The notice contained an error; the approved window did not change.

3. Which consequence is known?

- A** Every team lost data.
- B** The server failed on Tuesday.
- C** Nobody acted on the notice.
- D** One team moved its export schedule.

[Answers and explanations: page 97.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change record

Record describing a proposed change and its review or approval status.

IN USE consult the approved change record

change owner

The role responsible for a proposed or approved change.

IN USE identify the change owner

change approval

Permission to carry out a specified change.

IN USE verify change approval

maintenance notice

A communication of planned service work and impact.

IN USE correct a maintenance notice

maintenance window

The authorized time period for planned work.

IN USE confirm the maintenance window

release

A version or package made available under a process.

IN USE coordinate a software release

deployment

Introduction of a release or configuration into an environment.

IN USE distinguish release from deployment

rollback plan

An approved route for returning to an earlier state.

IN USE review the rollback plan

implementation plan

The defined plan for carrying out a change.

IN USE confirm the implementation plan

validation

Checks that a change meets its intended requirements.

IN USE record post-change validation

stakeholder

A person or group with an interest in the outcome.

IN USE identify affected stakeholders

recipient list

The designated audience for a message.

IN USE reconcile the recipient list

Precision check

A mistaken notice is not automatically a changed authorization. "The date has moved" would imply an actual schedule change; "the Tuesday date was incorrect" identifies the communication error. Preserve the exact time zone.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

correction

A statement replacing inaccurate information.

IN USE issue an explicit correction

supersede

Replace an earlier record or statement as controlling.

IN USE supersede the earlier notice

source of truth

The agreed authoritative record for a particular fact.

IN USE name the source of truth

acknowledgment

Confirmation of receipt or understanding.

IN USE request acknowledgment

dependency

Work or a condition another action relies on.

IN USE identify a scheduling dependency

change freeze

A defined restriction on changes during a period.

IN USE check the change-freeze policy

emergency change

A change handled under an authorized urgent process.

IN USE follow the emergency-change route

problem record

A record tracking an underlying cause or recurring issue.

IN USE open a problem record

known error

A recognized problem with documented diagnostic context or handling.

IN USE document a known error

post-implementation review

Review of a change's outcome after implementation.

IN USE conduct a post-implementation review

action owner

The person accountable for an agreed follow-up.

IN USE name the action owner

due date

The agreed date by which an action is expected.

IN USE confirm the action due date

Precision check

Acknowledgment confirms receipt or understanding; it does not approve the change. A corrected notice supersedes the inaccurate communication, while the approved change record remains the authority for the work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OWN THE ERROR

"The Tuesday date in my earlier notice was incorrect."

REPLACE THE OLD RECORD

"This correction supersedes the earlier maintenance notice."

ACKNOWLEDGE IMPACT

"I understand your team rescheduled an export based on that message."

NAME THE AUTHORITY

"The approved change record remains the source of truth."

STATE THE APPROVED FACT

"The approved window is Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time."

AVOID A FALSE HISTORY

"The approved window has not changed; the notice was wrong."

REQUEST CONFIRMATION

"Please confirm that the corrected date has reached the affected team."

CLOSE WITH AN OWNER

"I will send the correction and contact the team that already changed its schedule."

Was incorrect versus changed

The correct response corrects a statement; the second describes a change in the underlying fact.

Supersedes

This verb states which communication takes precedence when two versions circulate.

Apology with action

"I am sorry for the confusion; here is the corrected window" pairs accountability with useful information.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE AUDIENCE

"Use the original recipient list and any known forwarded recipients."

DISTINGUISH RECEIPT

"Acknowledging this correction does not provide change approval."

AVOID AN ASSUMPTION

"We should not assume a second email has been read."

SEPARATE FOLLOW-UP

"Review how the mismatch occurred after the immediate correction is sent."

PRESERVE THE ZONE

"Include local branch time in the subject and body where appropriate."

CHECK DEPENDENCIES

"Which other scheduled work depended on the incorrect date?"

RECORD THE CONSEQUENCE

"Note the export rescheduling as a known impact of the error."

MAKE ACTION TESTABLE

"Assign an owner to verify the notice against the approved record before sending."

Local time

Name the relevant location or time zone rather than assuming every recipient reads the same clock.

Please confirm that

This requests confirmation of a specific fact, not a vague reply such as "looks good."

Passive alternatives

"An error was made" hides the responsible action; "I sent the wrong date" is clearer when that responsibility is known.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which subject line matches the facts?

- A** Maintenance moved from approved Tuesday to Thursday
- B** Tuesday maintenance successfully completed
- C** All future maintenance canceled
- D** Correction: Thursday maintenance window; Tuesday date was incorrect

2. Which sentence identifies the controlling communication?

- A** Please choose whichever message suits your team.
- B** This correction supersedes the earlier notice.
- C** Here is another note for your information.
- D** Both dates may remain useful.

3. What does receipt acknowledgment establish?

- A** That the recipient received or understood the correction
- B** That maintenance has been approved anew
- C** That every forwarded recipient has read it
- D** That the export has already been restored to its old schedule

4. Which follow-up is concrete and accountable?

- A** Delete all evidence of the first message.
- B** Name an owner to verify future notices against the approved record.
- C** Ask everyone to be more careful indefinitely.
- D** Assume the error cannot happen twice.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

Correct the maintenance date before users act on it

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

correction / Acknowledgment / dependency / action owner / maintenance window / recipient list / impact / audit trail / source of truth / supersedes

- 01 **Mina:** I found an error in yesterday's maintenance notice. I wrote Tuesday from eight to nine, but the approved record says Thursday during that same hour.
- 02 **Owen:** We need an explicit ¹ _____ before more teams act on it. Has any work started, or is this still only a communication mismatch?
- 03 **Mina:** The maintenance has not begun. One team moved its invoice export because of my notice, so there is already a scheduling consequence even without a service interruption.
- 04 **Owen:** Include that known ² _____. We should correct the date and contact that team directly rather than assume the general email will resolve everything.
- 05 **Mina:** Should I title the message maintenance moved to Thursday? That sounds concise, but it could imply Tuesday was once the authorized schedule, which it was not.
- 06 **Owen:** Exactly. Say the Tuesday date was incorrect and state the approved ³ _____. The authorization did not change; our message failed to match it.
- 07 **Mina:** I will include Thursday, eight to nine p.m., local branch time. I also need to say that the new message replaces the earlier notice in case both circulate.
- 08 **Owen:** Use ⁴ _____. That makes the relationship explicit. Put the correct date prominently so recipients do not have to compare paragraphs to find it.
- 09 **Mina:** I have the original mailing list. Some managers may have forwarded the message, so the first list may not include everyone who now has the wrong date.
- 10 **Owen:** Reconcile the ⁵ _____ and ask managers to pass on the correction where needed. Do not claim that sending one email proves everyone received the right information.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mina:** For the team that moved the export, I will apologize and ask whether the corrected window conflicts with their revised schedule. I cannot change that schedule on their behalf.
- 12 **Owen:** Good. Identify the ⁶ _____ and let its owner confirm the adjustment. Acknowledge the disruption without promising an action you do not own.
- 13 **Mina:** Do we need fresh change approval because I am issuing a corrected notice, or does the existing approved record remain valid for Thursday's work?
- 14 **Owen:** The approved record remains the ⁷ _____ for this case. We are correcting its communication, not requesting a different window or scope.
- 15 **Mina:** I'll call the export team as well. I need to know they've seen the correct time and whether it creates another scheduling problem.
- 16 **Owen:** Precisely. ⁸ _____ and authorization are different. The team's reply can confirm that they know the right time and identify remaining scheduling conflicts.
- 17 **Mina:** After the urgent correction, we should review how the wrong date entered the notice. I copied an earlier planning note instead of checking the approved record.
- 18 **Owen:** Record a concrete follow-up with an ⁹ _____: verify the date, scope, and time zone against the approved record before each notice is sent.
- 19 **Mina:** I'll send it now and call the export team next. I'll let you know this afternoon if anyone still has a conflict with Thursday.
- 20 **Owen:** Thank you. Keep the correction and its ¹⁰ _____. Clear replacement, accurate timing, and accountable follow-up matter more than making the original mistake disappear.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. correction | 2. impact | 3. maintenance window | 4. supersedes | 5. recipient list | 6. dependency | 7. source of truth | 8. Acknowledgment | 9. action owner | 10. audit trail

A release notice lists the wrong version

F Say it

A notice says version 4.2 will be deployed. The approved record specifies version 4.1. Deployment has not begun, and the approved version has not changed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval / incorrect / truth / supersedes

Communicator: "The 4.2 reference was ¹ _____; the approved version is 4.1."

Coordinator: "State that the correction ² _____ the earlier notice."

Communicator: "The approved record remains the source of ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Ask recipients to acknowledge the correction, not to provide new ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. incorrect | 2. supersedes | 3. truth | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the answers. Read Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time as the approved window; Tuesday was a notice error.
2. Switch roles. Send the correction to the original recipients and address the known export rescheduling; do not describe a newly changed approval.
3. Complete the version exchange. Preserve approved version 4.1 and correct the erroneous 4.2 notice without suggesting deployment has begun.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

A Read the situation

Challenge a narrow health claim and coordinate investigation around user-visible evidence.

The checkout service's dashboard shows normal server CPU usage. Five users report slow checkout during the last half hour. Request-duration and database-wait data have not yet been reviewed. Pat owns the application; Suri coordinates the platform team. The service runs in Kubernetes. There is no confirmed cause or approved production change. Both teams can review approved telemetry and agree on the next investigation owner.

PEOPLE / Pat: Application engineer | Suri: Platform engineer

08

A HEALTHY COMPONENT IS NOT A HEALTHY JOURNEY

A dashboard can be correct and incomplete. Normal CPU describes one resource measure, not the entire user transaction. Invite application and platform evidence together instead of using a green panel to dismiss user reports or assign blame.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which metric has been reviewed?

A Database wait time

C Every user's network path

B End-to-end checkout duration

D Server CPU usage

2. What do the five reports establish?

A Kubernetes is definitely at fault.

C Every customer is unable to buy.

B The database has failed.

D Five users experienced slow checkout in the reported period.

3. What is authorized now?

A Ignore the reports until every user complains

C Make any production change without review

B Review approved telemetry and coordinate investigation ownership

D Declare the incident resolved from CPU alone

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

platform

Shared technical services supporting applications.

IN USE coordinate with the platform team

DevOps

Collaborative practices linking software delivery and operations.

IN USE clarify DevOps responsibilities

Kubernetes

A platform for managing containerized workloads and services.

IN USE inspect Kubernetes workload status

cluster

A group of machines or resources managed together.

IN USE review cluster-level signals

node

A machine participating in a Kubernetes cluster.

IN USE inspect node resource usage

pod

A Kubernetes unit containing one or more containers.

IN USE check pod readiness

container

An isolated execution environment packaged with application dependencies.

IN USE inspect container logs

deployment

A Kubernetes resource managing a desired set of replicated pods.

IN USE review the deployment status

service

In Kubernetes, an abstraction exposing a group of endpoints.

IN USE inspect the service endpoints

ingress

A resource defining external HTTP or HTTPS routing to services.

IN USE review ingress routing

readiness

Whether an instance is ready to receive service traffic.

IN USE check readiness status

liveness

Whether a running instance should be considered alive under its check.

IN USE distinguish liveness from readiness

Precision check

A Kubernetes readiness check reports a configured condition, not universal correctness of every user transaction. CPU utilization is one metric; waiting on another component can produce slow responses without high CPU on the observed server.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

replica

A copy of an application instance maintained for a workload.

IN USE compare replica behavior

resource request

A declared resource amount used in scheduling decisions.

IN USE review resource requests

resource limit

A configured ceiling governing resource use.

IN USE inspect resource limits

CPU

Central processing unit; processing capacity measured by the panel.

IN USE inspect CPU utilization

observability

Ability to understand system behavior from emitted signals.

IN USE improve service observability

metric

A numerical measurement collected over time.

IN USE correlate service metrics

log

A recorded event or message from a system.

IN USE review application logs

trace

A connected record of a request across components.

IN USE follow a distributed trace

span

A timed operation within a distributed trace.

IN USE identify a slow span

saturation

Capacity pressure at the most constrained resource, often reflected in waits.

IN USE investigate resource saturation

database wait

Time spent awaiting a database resource or response.

IN USE measure database wait time

user journey

The sequence of actions producing a user-visible outcome.

IN USE monitor the checkout user journey

Precision check

In Kubernetes, Deployment and Service have specific resource meanings; in general IT discussion the same words have broader uses. Name the resource or user-facing function to avoid talking past another team.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

VALIDATE BOTH OBSERVATIONS

"The CPU panel is normal, and users are reporting slow checkout."

ASK ABOUT THE JOURNEY

"Which part of checkout is slow from the user's perspective?"

AVOID BLAME

"We have not isolated the application or platform as the cause."

NAME MISSING SIGNALS

"Database wait and complete request duration remain unchecked."

CHALLENGE THE INFERENCE

"That metric alone does not establish service health."

REQUEST TIMING

"Can we compare request durations during the reported half hour?"

FOLLOW THE REQUEST

"Trace the transaction across the components rather than stopping at one panel."

ASSIGN THE NEXT REVIEW

"Application will review request traces; platform will check the corresponding resource signals."

08

And instead of but

"CPU is normal and checkout is slow" allows two compatible observations without dismissing either.

Does not establish

This challenges the strength of an inference without claiming that the metric itself is wrong.

By service

A clarification question identifies whether a word has a platform-specific or business meaning.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CLARIFY A RESOURCE

"By service, do you mean the user-facing checkout or the Kubernetes Service?"

CHECK THE TIME RANGE

"Are both dashboards showing the same interval and time zone?"

PRESERVE AUTHORIZATION

"Any production change still needs the approved route."

COORDINATE OWNERSHIP

"Who will combine the two teams' findings into the next update?"

LIMIT A HEALTH CHECK

"Readiness passes for its configured test; that is not a full checkout result."

SEPARATE MITIGATION

"A proposed restart is not yet a diagnosed remedy."

REPORT MEASURED IMPACT

"We have five reports; the full affected population is not yet known."

CLOSE PRECISELY

"We will keep the issue open until user-visible behavior is assessed."

08

During

Tie evidence to the reported period rather than comparing unrelated dashboard windows.

Not yet

This preserves pending diagnosis and avoids treating an untested remedy as confirmed.

Who will

Assign one accountable coordinator rather than leaving ownership implicit across teams.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement combines the evidence accurately?

- A** The database is confirmed to be the bottleneck.
- B** CPU is normal on the observed panel; checkout slowness still requires investigation.
- C** CPU is normal, so every user report is false.
- D** Kubernetes caused the slowdown because the service uses it.

08

2. Which question resolves the meaning of service in this discussion?

- A** Were the timestamps converted to the same zone?
- B** By service, do you mean checkout or the Kubernetes Service resource?
- C** Which monitoring panel was refreshed most recently?
- D** Which team owns the application's container image?

3. What could a distributed trace help identify?

- A** The root cause solely from the name of the slowest span
- B** Which recorded operation contributes to the request delay
- C** The total affected user population from one sampled request
- D** Whether every request without a trace completed normally

4. Which next step fits the stated authority?

- A** Review approved telemetry and coordinate findings before proposing a production change.
- B** Restart every component immediately without approval.
- C** Close the issue because readiness passes.
- D** Promise a fixed completion time without measurements.

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

Normal CPU does not prove checkout is healthy

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

saturation / user journey / span / trace / observability / change / readiness / handoff / metric / database wait

08

- 01 **Pat:** Five users reported slow checkout in the last half hour. The platform dashboard shows normal CPU, so one colleague says the service must be healthy.
- 02 **Suri:** The panel can be correct without supporting that conclusion. CPU is one ¹ _____, and we need evidence about the user-visible transaction rather than dismissing the reports.
- 03 **Pat:** I agree. I have not reviewed the request durations yet. The reports say checkout feels slow, but they do not identify whether payment or order confirmation is taking longer.
- 04 **Suri:** Start by clarifying the ² _____. We can then compare request timing during the reported period with the corresponding platform signals.
- 05 **Pat:** When you say the service is ready, do you mean checkout has been tested or that the Kubernetes readiness checks are passing for its pods?
- 06 **Suri:** I mean the configured ³ _____ checks pass. That is useful evidence about those checks, not proof that every checkout completes promptly.
- 07 **Pat:** Thanks for separating that. I can review the application trace for a reported transaction if we can match it to a request identifier and time.
- 08 **Suri:** A distributed ⁴ _____ should help us follow the path. Please preserve the exact interval and time zone so our teams compare the same events.
- 09 **Pat:** If the slow operation is a database call, would normal application CPU be consistent with that? People seem to expect every slowdown to make CPU high.
- 10 **Suri:** It could be consistent with waiting, but we have not checked ⁵ _____ yet. Describe that as a hypothesis until the timing evidence actually supports it.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Pat:** Then I'll start with the slowest recorded operation. If the trace has a gap, I'll flag it rather than guess what happened there.
- 12 **Suri:** Good. Inspect the relevant ⁶ _____, and avoid assuming that an uninstrumented interval contains no work. Missing telemetry is a limitation, not a zero-duration finding.
- 13 **Pat:** Should we restart the pods while the investigation continues? A colleague suggested it because that helped with a different issue last month, but this cause is unknown.
- 14 **Suri:** A restart would be a production ⁷ _____. It needs the approved route and a reasoned proposal. We should not turn the previous incident's remedy into this incident's diagnosis.
- 15 **Pat:** I'll take the request path. What can your team check at the same time? I'd rather split the work than have us both checking everything.
- 16 **Suri:** We will examine corresponding resource use, workload status, and relevant ⁸ _____ signals under our approved access. You can focus on application timing and the exact checkout steps.
- 17 **Pat:** Who will combine the findings for the next update? Separate team messages might sound contradictory if one says resources are normal and another says customers are waiting.
- 18 **Suri:** I will coordinate the ⁹ _____. We can report both observations, explain their scope, and identify the next owner without declaring either team at fault.
- 19 **Pat:** Then the issue stays open. We have five reports, not a verified total of affected users, and no confirmed cause or approved remedy at this point.
- 20 **Suri:** Exactly. Better ¹⁰ _____ means connecting the signals to the user outcome. We will report what the evidence establishes and what still needs investigation, even when the dashboard remains green.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. metric | 2. user journey | 3. readiness | 4. trace | 5. database wait | 6. span | 7. change | 8. saturation | 9. handoff | 10. observability

Readiness passes while a search request times out

F Say it

A search application's readiness check passes, but an authorized test request times out. The check only tests a lightweight endpoint. The search backend has not yet been reviewed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

trace / check / hypothesis / journey

Engineer: "The readiness ¹ _____ passes for the lightweight endpoint."

Reviewer: "That does not establish the complete search ² _____ is healthy."

Engineer: "I will inspect the request ³ _____ to locate the recorded delay."

Reviewer: "Keep the backend explanation as a ⁴ _____ until the evidence supports it."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. check | 2. journey | 3. trace | 4. hypothesis

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check the dialogue. Read normal CPU and five slow-checkout reports as compatible observations, not proof that either is false.
2. Switch roles. Name the unreviewed request-duration and database-wait evidence and coordinate the application and platform findings.
3. Complete the search exchange. Distinguish the lightweight readiness check from the timed-out search journey and keep the backend cause unconfirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The backup succeeded; the recovery exercise did not

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain a recovery-test shortfall using distinct time and data-loss measures.

A fictional recovery exercise starts at 10 a.m. The latest usable backup represents 2 a.m. data. Service is restored at 1:20 p.m. The approved objectives are a four-hour recovery point objective and a two-hour recovery time objective.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Systems administrator | Leah: Service owner

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

dependencies / recovery point / test record / acceptance criteria / elapsed time / restore duration

- 01 **Leah:** The backup dashboard is green. Can I mark the recovery exercise successful?
- 02 **Ravi:** Not against both objectives. We restored service, but the ¹ _____ was three hours and twenty minutes.
- 03 **Leah:** Our target is two hours. Where did the extra time go?
- 04 **Ravi:** Most of it went into restoring the data. I have separate timings for provisioning, restoration, and application checks.
- 05 **Leah:** And how current was the recovered data?
- 06 **Ravi:** The ² _____ was 2 a.m., eight hours before the exercise started.
- 07 **Leah:** So we also missed the four-hour data-loss objective.
- 08 **Ravi:** Yes. The job completed, but the available recovery point was older than the business requirement allows.
- 09 **Leah:** Can we solve that by scheduling more backups?
- 10 **Ravi:** That may help, but first we should check why the later copy wasn't usable. I don't want to prescribe a fix before that review.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Leah:** Agreed. What evidence should go in the report?
- 12 **Ravi:** The selected copy, its data timestamp, the ³ _____, and the application validation results.
- 13 **Leah:** Were the recovered records actually checked, or did we stop when the service started?
- 14 **Ravi:** We checked the agreed sample and the totals for that backup. The checks passed within that defined scope.
- 15 **Leah:** Then the summary needs both the successful restoration and the missed objectives.
- 16 **Ravi:** I'll show them separately in the ⁴ _____. No overall green status.
- 17 **Leah:** Who will propose the corrective work?
- 18 **Ravi:** I'll investigate the unusable copy. The storage team will review the duration. We'll bring you options with cost and ⁵ _____.
- 19 **Leah:** Good. We'll choose a plan, then schedule another exercise.
- 20 **Ravi:** And define the ⁶ _____ before rerunning it, including both objectives and the data checks.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. elapsed time | 2. recovery point | 3. restore duration | 4. test record | 5. dependencies | 6. acceptance criteria

A weekly status report confuses backup and recovery

F Say it in a new situation

A manager wants to report that nightly backups prove the application can recover within two hours. No timed recovery test has established that claim.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

verified / performance / recovery / objective

09

Manager: Can I describe two-hour recovery as ¹ _____?

Administrator: Not yet. We have backup-job results, not a timed
² _____ test.

Manager: I'll label two hours as the agreed ³ _____ instead.

Administrator: Good. The exercise will provide the missing ⁴ _____ evidence.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. verified | 2. recovery | 3. objective | 4. performance

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

An employee leaves, but three workflows still use the account

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Coordinate offboarding while separating identity access from business continuity.

An approved offboarding request ends a staff member's access at 5 p.m. Friday. A report subscription, a shared mailbox workflow, and a scheduled integration need new owners. Records must follow the organization's retention instructions.

PEOPLE / Tara: IT coordinator | Ben: Department manager

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

retention policy / validation / handover checklist / cutoff / service account / action owner

10

- 01 **Ben:** Can we leave Maya's account active for a week? Her reports still run from it.
- 02 **Tara:** The approved ¹ _____ is Friday at five. Let's transfer the work instead of extending personal access informally.
- 03 **Ben:** I hadn't realized the report subscription belonged to her rather than the team.
- 04 **Tara:** That's one item. There's also the shared mailbox workflow and a scheduled integration. Who can take responsibility for each?
- 05 **Ben:** I can own the reports. Jordan can coordinate the mailbox. I don't know enough about the integration.
- 06 **Tara:** I'll contact its service owner. A named ² _____ may be appropriate, subject to the approved design and access review.
- 07 **Ben:** Could Jordan simply use Maya's password while we sort this out?
- 08 **Tara:** No. We'll assign authorized access to Jordan's own identity. We need to know who performed each action.
- 09 **Ben:** Understood. Should I ask Maya to delete her old project files before she leaves?
- 10 **Tara:** Don't request deletion. The ³ _____ and any applicable hold instructions govern those records.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Ben:** I'll leave the records intact and identify the business owners.
- 12 **Tara:** Thanks. The access change and the records decision are separate tasks in the checklist.
- 13 **Ben:** How do we know the transferred report still works?
- 14 **Tara:** Run the approved ⁴ _____ with its new owner and delivery list. A changed owner field isn't enough.
- 15 **Ben:** I'll verify the report output. What happens if the integration isn't ready by Friday?
- 16 **Tara:** We escalate that continuity issue to the authorized owner. We don't silently cancel the access cutoff.
- 17 **Ben:** Please put that on the handover so the Friday team sees it.
- 18 **Tara:** I will, with an ⁵ _____ and status for each unresolved item.
- 19 **Ben:** Then we have three workflow transfers, one access deadline, and a separate records check.
- 20 **Tara:** Exactly. I'll send the ⁶ _____ for you to confirm today.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. cutoff | 2. service account | 3. retention policy | 4. validation | 5. action owner | 6. handover checklist

A report arrives after its owner has left

F Say it in a new situation

A recurring report still shows the former employee as its owner. The new manager has not verified its recipients or output.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

complete / transfer / validation / recipient

Manager: The report arrived, so can we close the ¹ _____ task?

IT: First confirm the new owner and the authorized ² _____ list.

Manager: I'll also compare the output with the agreed ³ _____ criteria.

IT: Then record the result before marking the handover ⁴ _____.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. transfer | 2. recipient | 3. validation | 4. complete

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The certificate renews tonight, but nobody owns the alert

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Clarify technical ownership and communicate a preventive change.

The customer portal's TLS certificate expires in six days. Automated renewal failed last night. The infrastructure team manages the renewal service; the application team validates the portal. No customer outage has been reported.

PEOPLE / Nia: Infrastructure engineer | Sol: Application owner

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

certificate / change record / validation plan / change window / on-call / handoff

11

- 01 **Sol:** I received an expiry warning for the portal. Is the site already down?
- 02 **Nia:** No outage is reported. The current ¹ _____ remains valid for six days, but last night's renewal failed.
- 03 **Sol:** I thought renewal was automatic. Why does this need our team?
- 04 **Nia:** Automation still needs monitoring and an owner when it fails. Infrastructure owns the renewal service; your team checks the application afterward.
- 05 **Sol:** What failed: issuance or installation?
- 06 **Nia:** The log shows issuance didn't complete. We haven't reached installation. I'm checking the approved renewal workflow now.
- 07 **Sol:** Can I tell Support there may be a planned outage?
- 08 **Nia:** Let's first define the ² _____ and expected impact. Don't announce downtime we haven't established.
- 09 **Sol:** Fair. What do you need from us today?
- 10 **Nia:** Confirm the portal endpoints and a tester. We'll document the renewal result and the certificate presented by each endpoint.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 Sol:** Our health check only confirms that the page responds.
- 12 Nia:** Then add the approved TLS checks to the ³ _____. A page response alone won't confirm the intended certificate is in use.
- 13 Sol:** Should users ignore a browser warning if one appears during the work?
- 14 Nia:** No. Route any warning through Support. We shouldn't ask users to bypass a security warning to keep working.
- 15 Sol:** Who gets the next failed-renewal alert?
- 16 Nia:** The infrastructure ⁴ _____ contact, with application ownership listed as the escalation contact.
- 17 Sol:** I'll verify that contact list. The current alert reached a mailbox nobody checks overnight.
- 18 Nia:** That explains the notification gap, not necessarily the renewal failure. I'll track the two issues separately.
- 19 Sol:** Please include both in the ⁵ _____ so we don't fix only the certificate.
- 20 Nia:** Agreed. We'll close it after the renewal, endpoint checks, and a tested alert ⁶ _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. certificate | 2. change window | 3. validation plan | 4. on-call | 5. change record | 6. handoff

Support receives a certificate-warning screenshot

F Say it in a new situation

A user reports a browser warning after the planned renewal. Support must gather evidence and escalate without asking the user to bypass it.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

message / warning / owner / address

User: Should I click past the ¹ _____ to reach the portal?

Support: No. Please report the exact portal ² _____ through our support channel.

User: I'll include the time and the wording of the ³ _____.

Support: I'll escalate it to the named ⁴ _____ and keep you updated.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. warning | 2. address | 3. message | 4. owner

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which function is confirmed to fail?

D. Exporting the current month's invoices

The briefing confirms an export error while sign-in and invoice viewing still work for Ren.

2. How many people have reported the export issue?

D. Three

Ren and two colleagues have reported it; the wider affected population is unknown.

3. What may Asha promise?

A. An escalation and a timed update

Asha can coordinate triage and escalation, but the briefing gives no confirmed repair time or authority over billing.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which ticket summary is most accurate?

C. Current-month export fails for three reported users; sign-in and viewing work for Ren.

The accurate summary preserves confirmed functions and reported scope without extending the evidence.

2. Which statement promises communication rather than repair?

D. I will send a progress update by noon.

An update can report incomplete findings; it does not guarantee that service will be restored.

3. Which question establishes business impact?

D. What work cannot proceed without that file?

The blocked task establishes business consequences. Error codes, comparison periods and ownership are useful triage details but answer different questions.

4. What does "three reported users" avoid claiming?

D. That the affected population is limited to three

Reported counts identify known reports, not a verified upper limit on all affected users.

01 Conversation answers

IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. impact.** Turn 2. Impact describes the work disrupted, here preparation of the billing file, rather than merely the technical error.
- 2. scope.** Turn 4. Scope identifies the affected function and population; the current evidence points to export rather than complete application unavailability.
- 3. symptom.** Turn 6. A symptom is the observed failure; its extent and underlying cause still need assessment before classifying the whole incident.
- 4. error message.** Turn 8. The error message gives diagnostic wording; it should be recorded without unnecessarily widening access to invoice data.
- 5. workaround.** Turn 10. A workaround reduces impact temporarily; an unverified manual copy may not produce the complete file needed for billing.
- 6. restoration time.** Turn 12. Restoration time concerns when service works again; it is different from a support response or scheduled update.
- 7. escalation.** Turn 14. Escalation brings the application specialists into the investigation; it does not itself establish a repair deadline.
- 8. duplicate ticket.** Turn 16. A duplicate ticket may refer to the same underlying incident; linking it preserves evidence without treating it as a separate resolved fault.
- 9. assignment group.** Turn 18. The assignment group identifies the team handling the next investigation step rather than the business user awaiting the result.
- 10. closure criterion.** Turn 20. A closure criterion states the evidence needed before marking the incident resolved, here a working export with the required file checks.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. failure

Analyst: "The confirmed failure is printing to that device, not document editing."

The user can edit and save; only printing to the named device is confirmed to fail.

2. printer

User: "I have not verified an alternative printer yet."

Another printer is untested, so it cannot be presented as a confirmed workaround.

3. restoration

Analyst: "I will report the meeting deadline separately from the unknown restoration time."

The meeting's deadline does not establish when the printer service will be restored.

4. update

User: "Please give me a timed update even if the repair is still pending."

A progress update is a controllable communication action and can accurately report an unfinished repair.

02 Briefing and language checks

Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which pattern is established?

D. Office access works; four VPN users report failure.

The reports establish an access-path difference, but no specific network mechanism has yet been tested.

2. Which cause is confirmed?

A. None of the proposed causes

The briefing explicitly says the relevant checks have not been performed.

3. What constraint applies to investigation?

C. Follow the approved process without changing production on a guess.

The case permits approved diagnosis, not speculative production changes or unsupported status claims.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement preserves the evidence boundary?

C. The VPN path is associated with the reported failures; the cause is unconfirmed.

The observed path difference is real, but the specific cause still requires testing.

2. Which question distinguishes the observed failure from a proposed cause?

D. Did the request time out, get refused, or show a certificate warning?

Asking for the actual observed outcome preserves symptoms. The alternatives assume mechanisms or causes that have not been tested.

3. What does a successful name lookup establish?

B. That this lookup returned a result under the tested conditions

Name resolution is one step and cannot certify later connectivity or authorization.

4. Which commitment is appropriate before diagnosis?

A. I will report the comparison results and remaining hypotheses.

A result-based update is achievable without promising an unverified repair or bypassing controls.

02 Conversation answers

Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. hypothesis.** Turn 2. A hypothesis is a proposed explanation; the path difference alone does not establish which network component caused it.
- 2. symptom.** Turn 4. The symptom is the observed failure, such as a timeout or warning, not the user's general description that the page will not open.
- 3. reachability.** Turn 6. Reachability concerns contacting the particular destination under the tested conditions; VPN connection status alone does not establish it.
- 4. name resolution.** Turn 8. Name resolution maps the portal name to records; comparing results helps assess the DNS hypothesis without assuming it is correct.
- 5. hostname.** Turn 10. The hostname identifies the specific named destination; a comparable investigation needs the same target rather than merely the same application description.
- 6. access policy.** Turn 12. An access policy governs permission under specified conditions; it is another possible explanation that requires its own evidence.
- 7. timeout.** Turn 14. A timeout means the waiting period expired; it differs from a completed but slow response or an explicit refusal.
- 8. time zone.** Turn 16. The time zone makes timestamps comparable across logs and reports; a clock time alone can point investigators to the wrong events.
- 9. comparison.** Turn 18. A comparison uses specified, comparable conditions; it can narrow explanations without turning an untested alternative into a finding.
- 10. diagnosis.** Turn 20. A diagnosis is an evidence-based explanation; revising an early theory is part of reaching it rather than a failure of the investigation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. warning

Analyst: "The reported symptom is a certificate warning, not a confirmed DNS failure."

The user reported a specific warning; the scenario contains no DNS finding.

2. timestamp

Engineer: "Record the hostname and the timestamp with its time zone."

A timestamp with time zone helps authorized reviewers match the reported event to the appropriate records.

3. hypothesis

Analyst: "The proxy path is another hypothesis to investigate."

The proxy has not been reviewed, so its involvement is a proposed explanation rather than a conclusion.

4. bypass

Engineer: "Follow the approved process; do not ask the user to bypass the warning."

The case authorizes investigation, not circumventing a security warning or changing trust decisions.

03 Briefing and language checks

Identity, Access, and Permissions

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What task does Jo need to perform?

C. Download a monthly report

The stated need is a report download, not general administrative control.

2. Who approves the system role?

A. The system owner

The manager confirms business need, while the system owner has role-approval authority in this case.

3. What remains unverified?

D. Whether the reporting role permits the download

The reporting role is a possible fit, not yet a verified authorization solution.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which request is best scoped?

D. Access to download the named monthly report for the assignment period

The correct request states a resource, action, and duration without adding unrelated permissions.

2. Which statement distinguishes authentication from authorization?

B. Signing in does not prove permission to download the report.

Identity verification and permission to perform a specific action are separate controls.

3. Who should confirm business need in this case?

D. Jo's manager

The case assigns business-need confirmation to Jo's manager; role approval remains the system owner's separate decision.

4. Which status is accurate before approval?

B. Submitted for review; access has not been granted.

Submission starts review; it does not establish approval, provisioning, or permanent entitlement.

03 Conversation answers

Identity, Access, and Permissions

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. permission.** Turn 2. A permission authorizes a particular action; the required download does not itself justify broad administrative control.
- 2. business justification.** Turn 4. The business justification states the work-related need, here report analysis, rather than adopting the requested privilege level without examination.
- 3. Authentication.** Turn 6. Authentication establishes identity evidence; it does not automatically authorize every action within the application.
- 4. entitlements.** Turn 8. Entitlements are the specific granted rights attached to the role or account; a helpful role name does not prove the necessary download right.
- 5. approver.** Turn 10. The approver is the person authorized to make this access decision; confirming a business need is not the same decision.
- 6. expiration.** Turn 12. Expiration specifies when the entitlement should end, matching temporary access to the stated assignment rather than leaving it open indefinitely.
- 7. credentials.** Turn 14. Credentials establish access to an identity; sharing them can obscure who acted and does not authorize the recipient's use.
- 8. least privilege.** Turn 16. Least privilege limits access to the legitimate task; urgency affects handling speed, not the necessary breadth of permissions.
- 9. provisioning.** Turn 18. Provisioning is the actual assignment of the approved access; an approval message does not prove that assignment has already occurred.
- 10. deprovisioning.** Turn 20. Deprovisioning removes access no longer required; assigning its ownership makes the temporary-access end condition actionable.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. viewing

Analyst: "The requested action is viewing, not editing or administration."

The contractor's stated task is to view one dashboard; additional control is not justified by that task.

2. approval

Manager: "I can confirm the business need, but the owner provides approval."

The case separates confirmation of need from the owner's authorization decision.

3. duration

Analyst: "The request will include a two-week duration."

The access period should match the temporary task instead of becoming indefinite.

4. pending

Manager: "Until review is complete, describe the access as pending."

No approval has been recorded, so granted or active would overstate the current status.

04 Briefing and language checks

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which cost difference is confirmed?

B. Only Option B includes backup storage.

The briefing identifies backup inclusion as different and leaves transfer and support unconfirmed.

2. What is the headline difference?

B. \$250 per month

Subtracting \$800 from \$1,050 gives \$250, but that is not a verified like-for-like saving.

3. Which conclusion is premature?

C. Option A is the cheaper complete solution.

The complete scope and missing charges are unresolved, so the cheaper headline cannot establish the cheaper complete service.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which comparison is defensible now?

A. A is \$250 lower before its missing backup and other unconfirmed costs are resolved.

The correct statement gives the arithmetic while preserving the unequal scope and unknown items.

2. How should an unconfirmed transfer charge appear?

D. Unknown, with the required assumption identified

Missing information must remain explicit; entering zero or included would invent a cost assumption.

3. Which question concerns RPO?

C. How far back may the recovered data point be relative to the disruption?

Recovery point objective concerns the tolerated data-loss interval. Restoration duration is RTO; retention duration and storage volume answer other planning questions.

4. What does included backup storage fail to establish?

D. That a successful restore has been tested

Storing a backup and demonstrating recoverability are separate matters.

04 Conversation answers

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. inclusions.** Turn 2. Inclusions identify what the quoted amount covers; unequal included services make headline totals unsuitable as equivalent-service savings.
- 2. headline difference.** Turn 4. The headline difference is the subtraction of the displayed estimates, not a verified saving after aligning their scope.
- 3. unknown.** Turn 6. Unknown preserves missing information; zero would falsely assert that the charge has been established as nothing.
- 4. consumption.** Turn 8. Consumption is actual or assumed resource use; estimates are meaningful only when the usage basis is explicit.
- 5. retention period.** Turn 10. The retention period states how long copies are kept; it affects scope and cost but does not prove successful recovery.
- 6. RPO.** Turn 12. Recovery point objective concerns the tolerated interval of data loss; it is distinct from the time needed to restore the service.
- 7. commitment.** Turn 14. A commitment can impose term or spending conditions; the displayed monthly equivalent does not fully describe those obligations.
- 8. line item.** Turn 16. A line item separates a cost or service component so its coverage and assumptions can be compared explicitly.
- 9. like-for-like.** Turn 18. Like-for-like means comparing equivalent scope and assumptions, rather than selecting between superficially similar but different totals.
- 10. audit trail.** Turn 20. An audit trail records the assumptions and decisions supporting the estimate, so later reviewers can understand why a recommendation was made.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. scope

Analyst: "The \$2,000 difference compares unequal scope."

The two quotes differ in migration coverage, so their totals do not yet describe equivalent services.

2. exclusion

Manager: "List migration as an exclusion from A, not an assumed free service."

Quote A explicitly leaves migration out; treating it as free would invent an inclusion.

3. unknown

Analyst: "I will keep the additional amount marked unknown until it is confirmed."

No amount has been established, so unknown is more accurate than zero.

4. like-for-like

Manager: "Then request a like-for-like comparison before recommending a purchase."

Aligning the migration scope and other assumptions makes the cost comparison decision-relevant.

05 Briefing and language checks

Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management

A Briefing checks / page 40

05

1. How many laptops report successful installation?

B. 180

The console reports 180 successes; offline devices and installation errors are separate remaining groups.

2. What is known about the remaining twenty?

B. Twelve were offline and eight returned errors.

The briefing gives two unresolved states and explicitly says no exception has been approved.

3. Why is complete premature?

C. Not all devices are installed and verified under the stated criteria.

Installation remains unresolved for twenty devices, and verification is not complete for all reported successes.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which status statement is accurate?

A. 180 installed; twelve offline; eight errors; verification still in progress.

The correct statement preserves each known state without inventing completion, exceptions, or verification failures.

2. What percentage reports successful installation?

D. 90 percent

Dividing 180 successful reports by 200 in-scope devices gives 90 percent.

3. Which action would distort the report?

C. Removing offline devices from scope without an approved change

Unapproved removal changes the denominator to improve appearance rather than reflect the agreed scope.

4. Which statement describes a plan rather than a result?

B. A retry is scheduled for the eight errors.

Scheduled identifies intended future work; it does not establish the retry outcome.

05 Conversation answers

Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. installation. Turn 2. Installation is the software's reported setup state; it is not automatically the complete verified deployment state.

2. completion criterion. Turn 4. The completion criterion defines the evidence required for done; an installation percentage does not replace the required verification.

3. offline. Turn 6. Offline identifies devices unavailable to the management system; it does not assert that an installation was attempted and failed.

4. denominator. Turn 8. The denominator is the total in-scope count; changing it without approval would make the percentage misleading.

5. error codes. Turn 10. Error codes identify reported conditions that may require different responses; the count alone cannot establish that a retry will succeed.

6. reboot. Turn 12. A reboot is a restart; if required for the approved state, installation alone is not enough to claim verification.

7. exception. Turn 14. An exception is an approved departure with conditions, not a label the team applies simply because a device remains unresolved.

8. inventory. Turn 16. The inventory identifies the in-scope devices and their attributes; a verification-pending subset must not be added to the installed group as if it contained additional devices.

9. remediation. Turn 18. Remediation is the work assigned to correct outstanding deficiencies; naming it does not claim that those deficiencies are already corrected.

10. criteria. Turn 20. Criteria are the conditions defining acceptable completion; clear reporting follows those conditions rather than an attractive percentage.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. reboot

Engineer: "Installation is reported successful, but a reboot is still pending."

The required restart has not occurred, so the installation status cannot imply the final operational state.

2. verification

Owner: "Then the service check is still part of verification."

Verification checks that the required state and service behavior have actually been achieved.

3. complete

Engineer: "I will describe the update as in progress, not complete."

The required restart and service check remain unfinished, so complete would overstate the evidence.

4. criteria

Owner: "Keep the approved recovery route available until the criteria are met."

The completion conditions, not the installation message alone, determine when the work can be closed.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is confirmed?

A. An unusual-sign-in alert occurred at 09:12 UTC.

The alert and its timestamp are known; legitimacy, compromise, and data impact remain unconfirmed.

2. Who decides containment under this case's process?

B. Authorized responders

The briefing assigns containment decisions to authorized responders, not to every person seeing the alert.

3. Where should detailed evidence be placed?

C. The approved restricted evidence channel

Use the designated evidence route. An unconfirmed classification, a personal copy or partial redaction does not make another destination approved.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which initial report is accurate?

D. Unusual-sign-in alert at 09:12 UTC; owner confirmation and scope review pending.

The accurate report supplies the known event and missing checks without prematurely confirming or dismissing the issue.

2. What does "owner confirmation pending" establish?

B. Confirmation has not been completed.

Pending identifies an unfinished check and does not supply either possible outcome.

3. Which question clarifies response ownership?

D. Who has accepted responsibility for the containment decision under the approved process?

The question asks for an accepted, authorized decision responsibility. Seeing an alert, sending an update or possessing access does not establish that ownership.

4. Which statement overclaims scope?

C. Every account is affected because one alert fired.

A single account alert cannot establish that every account is affected without further investigation.

06 Conversation answers

Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. restricted channel. Turn 2. The restricted channel keeps detailed account evidence available to authorized responders without broadly distributing it.

2. alert. Turn 4. An alert is a signal requiring assessment; it does not alone establish unauthorized access or compromise.

3. geolocation. Turn 6. Geolocation is an estimate based on available signals; it is not verified evidence of the person's physical location.

4. scope assessment. Turn 8. A scope assessment determines what accounts, assets, or data are affected; an unreviewed area cannot be declared unaffected.

5. containment. Turn 10. Containment limits possible consequences and is an operational decision for the role authorized in this case.

6. timeline. Turn 12. A timeline orders events using comparable timestamps; inconsistent time zones can lead reviewers to associate the wrong records.

7. classification. Turn 14. Classification records the assessed type or status of the event; one new statement should be handled through the approved review rather than automatic closure.

8. notification. Turn 16. Notification decisions concern designated recipients and applicable obligations; they have authorized owners separate from the initial alert reporter.

9. need-to-know. Turn 18. Need-to-know limits detailed information to people who require it for their role, while allowing a suitable broader status summary.

10. under review. Turn 20. Under review accurately marks an unresolved assessment; it neither clears the alert nor confirms a breach before the evidence supports either result.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. confirmed

Analyst: "The email is reported suspicious; malicious content is not yet confirmed."

A report identifies a concern, but analysis has not established what the attachment contains.

2. route

Coordinator: "Use the approved reporting route for the original message."

The defined route sends the evidence to authorized reviewers instead of encouraging informal redistribution.

3. unknown

Analyst: "Whether anyone interacted with it remains unknown."

No interaction has been confirmed, which is not evidence that interaction either did or did not occur.

4. know

Coordinator: "Keep the wider update limited to the audience's need to know."

The need-to-know principle restricts unnecessary distribution of potentially sensitive incident information.

07 Briefing and language checks

Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Which window is approved?

B. Thursday, 8 to 9 p.m., local branch time

The approved change record specifies Thursday evening in local branch time.

2. What actually changed?

D. The notice contained an error; the approved window did not change.

The case distinguishes a mistaken communication from a change to the authorized schedule.

3. Which consequence is known?

D. One team moved its export schedule.

The briefing identifies one concrete downstream scheduling consequence without establishing wider damage.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which subject line matches the facts?

D. Correction: Thursday maintenance window; Tuesday date was incorrect

The correct response corrects the message without inventing a change to the approved schedule or completed work.

2. Which sentence identifies the controlling communication?

B. This correction supersedes the earlier notice.

Supersedes explicitly replaces the inaccurate notice and reduces competing interpretations.

3. What does receipt acknowledgment establish?

A. That the recipient received or understood the correction

Receipt or understanding is narrower than approval or completion of downstream actions.

4. Which follow-up is concrete and accountable?

B. Name an owner to verify future notices against the approved record.

A named verification action can be performed and checked; vague intentions and deleted history do not create that control.

07 Conversation answers

Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. correction. Turn 2. A correction replaces inaccurate information; another unexplained message could leave both dates appearing valid.

2. impact. Turn 4. Impact includes the team's changed work schedule; the absence of an outage does not mean the mistaken notice had no consequences.

3. maintenance window. Turn 6. The maintenance window is the authorized work period, which remains Thursday from eight to nine in this case.

4. supersedes. Turn 8. Supersedes states that the corrected communication replaces the earlier one as the version recipients should use.

5. recipient list. Turn 10. The recipient list identifies the message audience; known forwarding may require further communication beyond the original addressees.

6. dependency. Turn 12. A dependency is scheduled work affected by another condition; the export plan may now depend on confirmation of the maintenance timing.

7. source of truth. Turn 14. The source of truth is the agreed authoritative record; the communication correction does not itself alter or renew the underlying approval.

8. Acknowledgment. Turn 16. Acknowledgment confirms receipt or understanding, not permission to carry out the change or proof that every resulting action is finished.

9. action owner. Turn 18. An action owner is accountable for completing the agreed improvement, making follow-up more specific than a general request to be careful.

10. audit trail. Turn 20. The audit trail preserves what was sent, corrected, and confirmed, allowing later review without hiding the original communication error.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. incorrect

Communicator: "The 4.2 reference was incorrect; the approved version is 4.1."

The error is in the notice; the approved version remains 4.1.

2. supersedes

Coordinator: "State that the correction supersedes the earlier notice."

Supersedes tells readers which communication replaces the inaccurate version.

3. truth

Communicator: "The approved record remains the source of truth."

The controlled record, not either informal assumption, governs the authorized version.

4. approval

Coordinator: "Ask recipients to acknowledge the correction, not to provide new approval."

Receipt of a corrected notice is distinct from authorizing a different deployment.

08 Briefing and language checks

Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which metric has been reviewed?

D. Server CPU usage

The briefing confirms only the CPU panel; the other evidence has not been reviewed.

2. What do the five reports establish?

D. Five users experienced slow checkout in the reported period.

The reports establish a user-visible symptom, not a cause or the total affected population.

3. What is authorized now?

B. Review approved telemetry and coordinate investigation ownership

The case authorizes evidence review and coordination, not unapproved changes or unsupported resolution.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which statement combines the evidence accurately?

B. CPU is normal on the observed panel; checkout slowness still requires investigation.

A normal resource measure can coexist with slow transactions; the cause remains unconfirmed.

2. Which question resolves the meaning of service in this discussion?

B. By service, do you mean checkout or the Kubernetes Service resource?

Asking which meaning of service is intended separates the user-facing function from a named platform resource. The other questions concern freshness, ownership and time alignment.

3. What could a distributed trace help identify?

B. Which recorded operation contributes to the request delay

A trace records operations and timing for the traced request. Sampling limits and investigation are still needed before wider scope or causal conclusions.

4. Which next step fits the stated authority?

A. Review approved telemetry and coordinate findings before proposing a production change.

The case permits investigation and coordination, while changes and outcome promises need further evidence and approval.

08 Conversation answers

Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. metric.** Turn 2. A metric measures a specified property; normal CPU does not establish the performance of the complete checkout transaction.
- 2. user journey.** Turn 4. The user journey names the sequence producing the customer's outcome; a symptom should be located within that sequence.
- 3. readiness.** Turn 6. Readiness reports whether an instance meets its configured traffic-acceptance check; it is not a complete test of every checkout behavior.
- 4. trace.** Turn 8. A trace connects recorded operations across components for a request, helping locate where time is spent.
- 5. database wait.** Turn 10. Database wait is time awaiting database work or resources; it is a plausible source of delay, not yet a finding here.
- 6. span.** Turn 12. A span records a timed operation within the trace; it can show a contribution to delay without proving every unrecorded cause.
- 7. change.** Turn 14. A production change requires the approved decision route; success on a previous unrelated issue does not authorize or establish this remedy.
- 8. saturation.** Turn 16. Saturation concerns pressure on constrained capacity; waiting and resource signals complement request traces without assuming a normal CPU panel covers every resource.
- 9. handoff.** Turn 18. A handoff combines the evidence and next responsibility so separate observations are not mistaken for conflicting conclusions.
- 10. observability.** Turn 20. Observability is the ability to understand system behavior from its signals; useful interpretation connects those signals to user-visible outcomes.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. check

Engineer: "The readiness check passes for the lightweight endpoint."

The passing result belongs to the configured endpoint check, not the full search transaction.

2. journey

Reviewer: "That does not establish the complete search journey is healthy."

The complete user journey includes work beyond the lightweight readiness endpoint.

3. trace

Engineer: "I will inspect the request trace to locate the recorded delay."

A request trace can connect operations and timings along the path of the failing search.

4. hypothesis

Reviewer: "Keep the backend explanation as a hypothesis until the evidence supports it."

The backend has not been reviewed, so its involvement remains a proposed explanation.

08

09 Conversation answers

The backup succeeded; the recovery exercise did not

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. elapsed time. Turn 2. Elapsed time is the interval actually taken, here from 10 a.m. to 1:20 p.m.

2. recovery point. Turn 6. Recovery point identifies the time represented by recovered data, not when restoration finished.

3. restore duration. Turn 12. Restore duration is the time spent recovering data, one part of the overall recovery time.

4. test record. Turn 16. Test record preserves the conditions, observations, and results of the recovery exercise.

5. dependencies. Turn 18. Dependencies are prerequisites or other work that the proposed corrective actions rely on.

6. acceptance criteria. Turn 20. Acceptance criteria specify the conditions the next exercise must meet before it can pass.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. verified

Manager: Can I describe two-hour recovery as verified?

Verified means supported by completed checks, which this claim currently lacks.

2. recovery

Administrator: Not yet. We have backup-job results, not a timed recovery test.

Recovery tests whether the service and data can be restored as required.

3. objective

Manager: I'll label two hours as the agreed objective instead.

Objective describes a required target rather than an already measured result.

4. performance

Administrator: Good. The exercise will provide the missing performance evidence.

Performance evidence shows what the recovery process actually achieved under test conditions.

10 Conversation answers

An employee leaves, but three workflows still use the account

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. cutoff. Turn 2. Cutoff is the specified time after which the departing employee's access must end.

2. service account. Turn 6. Service account means an identity for an automated process rather than a departing employee's personal identity.

3. retention policy. Turn 10. Retention policy determines how records are kept and disposed of; departure alone does not authorize deletion.

4. validation. Turn 14. Validation checks that the transferred workflow meets its intended requirements under the new ownership.

5. action owner. Turn 18. Action owner identifies the person responsible for carrying out a particular follow-up task.

6. handover checklist. Turn 20. Handover checklist records the tasks and confirmations needed to transfer responsibility without omissions.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. transfer

Manager: The report arrived, so can we close the transfer task?

Transfer refers to moving workflow responsibility, which requires more than successful delivery.

2. recipient

IT: First confirm the new owner and the authorized recipient list.

Recipient identifies who is permitted and expected to receive the report.

3. validation

Manager: I'll also compare the output with the agreed validation criteria.

Validation criteria state what the new owner must check before accepting the workflow.

4. complete

IT: Then record the result before marking the handover complete.

Complete means all agreed handover conditions have been satisfied and recorded.

11 Conversation answers

The certificate renews tonight, but nobody owns the alert

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. certificate. Turn 2. Certificate is the signed digital credential used in the portal's secure connection.

2. change window. Turn 8. Change window is the agreed period for planned service work, not a prediction of an outage.

3. validation plan. Turn 12. Validation plan specifies the checks needed to establish that the change works as intended.

4. on-call. Turn 16. On-call identifies the person or team assigned to respond during the relevant period.

5. change record. Turn 19. Change record documents the planned work, responsibilities, checks, and relevant evidence.

6. handoff. Turn 20. Handoff transfers the alert and response responsibility to a confirmed receiving owner.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. warning

User: Should I click past the warning to reach the portal?

Warning is the browser's security notice, not a routine confirmation to dismiss.

2. address

Support: No. Please report the exact portal address through our support channel.

Address identifies the endpoint involved and helps distinguish different portal routes.

3. message

User: I'll include the time and the wording of the message.

Message supplies the observed error text rather than a guessed diagnosis.

4. owner

Support: I'll escalate it to the named owner and keep you updated.

Owner is the person responsible for investigating and coordinating the issue.

11

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 IT Service Language, Tickets, and Triage

Acknowledge impact: I understand the export is blocking your billing file.

Establish scope: Who else has tried the same export and seen the error?

Read back the issue: Sign-in and viewing work; the current-month export fails for three reported users.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Networks, Connectivity, and Root-Cause Hypotheses

Acknowledge a pattern: The reports do point to a difference between access paths.

Request exact wording: Was it a timeout, a refusal, or a certificate warning?

Close the inference: The pattern narrows the investigation; it does not yet establish a cause.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Identity, Access, and Permissions

Clarify the action: Which report do you need, and what action must you perform?

Offer a narrower route: Let us verify whether the reporting role covers that download.

Confirm the request: I will submit the task, resource, duration, and approval route together.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Cloud, Infrastructure, and Cost-Aware Operations

Identify the mismatch: The estimates do not include the same services.

Request a common basis: Can we compare both options against the same workload and retention assumptions?

Bound the recommendation: I cannot recommend the lower total until the missing items are priced.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Endpoints, Servers, Patching, and Configuration Management

Report the counts: Installation succeeded on 180 of 200 managed laptops.

Reject an overstatement: I would report progress, not mark the deployment complete.

Set the next action: Assign owners for the offline follow-up, errors, and verification.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Security Operations, Risk, and Incident Response

Lead with the event: An unusual-sign-in alert was recorded at 09:12 UTC.

Avoid a premature label: We have not established compromise or data exposure.

Set the next update: The next update will distinguish confirmed findings from open questions.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Change, Release, Problem, and Post-Incident Communication

Own the error: The Tuesday date in my earlier notice was incorrect.

Avoid a false history: The approved window has not changed; the notice was wrong.

Close with an owner: I will send the correction and contact the team that already changed its schedule.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Platform, DevOps, Observability, and Kubernetes Conversations

Validate both observations: The CPU panel is normal, and users are reporting slow checkout.

Request timing: Can we compare request durations during the reported half hour?

Assign the next review: Application will review request traces; platform will check the corresponding resource signals.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

access denied report an access-denied message	24
access policy check the access policy	15
access request submit a scoped access request	24
access review conduct an access review	24
acknowledgment request acknowledgment	60
action owner name the action owner	60
administrator justify administrator access	23
affected user identify affected users	5
alert triage an alert	50
anomaly assess a sign-in anomaly	50
approver identify the correct approver	24
asset inventory reconcile the asset inventory	41
assignment group confirm the assignment group	6
audit log inspect the access audit log	24
authentication complete authentication	23
authorization check authorization	23
availability zone compare availability-zone designs	32
backup include backup storage	32
block storage size block-storage volumes	32
breach avoid an unverified breach claim	50
business justification document the business justification	24
cache inspect a cached response	14
certificate review a certificate warning	15
chain of custody maintain chain of custody	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

change approval verify change approval	59
change freeze check the change-freeze policy	60
change owner identify the change owner	59
change record consult the approved change record	59
closure criterion agree on closure criteria	6
cloud service compare cloud services	32
cluster review cluster-level signals	68
completion criterion state the completion criterion	42
compliance state report the compliance state	42
compromise investigate suspected compromise	50
configuration baseline compare with the configuration baseline	42
configuration drift detect configuration drift	42
connection refusal distinguish refusal from timeout	15
consumption forecast resource consumption	33
container inspect container logs	68
containment assign containment authority	51
correction issue an explicit correction	60
cost allocation document cost allocation	33
CPU inspect CPU utilization	69
database wait measure database wait time	69
dependency verify installation dependencies	42
dependency identify a scheduling dependency	60
deployment track deployment progress	41
deployment distinguish release from deployment	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

deployment review the deployment status	68
deployment ring review a deployment ring	42
deprovisioning schedule deprovisioning	23
DevOps clarify DevOps responsibilities	68
diagnostic hypothesis test a diagnostic hypothesis	15
DNS investigate a DNS hypothesis	14
due date confirm the action due date	60
duplicate ticket link a duplicate ticket	6
egress estimate egress charges	33
emergency change follow the emergency-change route	60
endpoint manage an endpoint	41
entitlement review account entitlements	23
eradication distinguish eradication from containment	51
error code group installation error codes	42
error message capture the error message	5
escalation request a technical escalation	6
escalation threshold apply the escalation threshold	51
event correlate security events	50
evidence preservation follow evidence-preservation requirements	51
exception document an approved exception	42
exclusion disclose estimate exclusions	33
expiration set an access expiration	24
false positive investigate a possible false positive	50
firewall review firewall logs	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

gateway identify the gateway	14
geolocation qualify a geolocation estimate	50
hostname confirm the hostname	14
identity verify the account identity	23
impact assess business impact	5
implementation plan confirm the implementation plan	59
incident report a service incident	5
indicator assess an indicator	50
infrastructure plan infrastructure capacity	32
ingress identify ingress traffic	33
ingress review ingress routing	68
installation confirm installation status	41
instance size a compute instance	32
IP address compare resolved IP addresses	14
knowledge article check the knowledge article	6
known error document a known error	60
Kubernetes inspect Kubernetes workload status	68
least privilege apply least privilege	23
line item compare each line item	33
liveness distinguish liveness from readiness	68
log review application logs	69
maintenance notice correct a maintenance notice	59
maintenance window schedule a maintenance window	41
maintenance window confirm the maintenance window	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

managed device	verify the managed-device inventory	41
metric	correlate service metrics	69
MFA	complete MFA verification	24
name resolution	verify name resolution	14
need to know	share on a need-to-know basis	51
node	inspect node resource usage	68
notification	confirm notification ownership	51
object storage	estimate object-storage usage	32
observability	improve service observability	69
offline	identify offline devices	41
on-call	contact the on-call responder	50
on-demand	estimate on-demand usage	33
packet loss	measure packet loss	15
patch	deploy an approved patch	41
patch level	confirm the patch level	41
permission	grant a specific permission	23
pilot group	validate the pilot group	42
platform	coordinate with the platform team	68
pod	check pod readiness	68
port	identify the service port	15
post-implementation review	conduct a post-implementation review	60
post-incident review	schedule a post-incident review	51
priority	assign a ticket priority	5
privileged access	review privileged access	23

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

problem record	open a problem record	60
provisioning	complete approved provisioning	23
proxy	identify the proxy path	15
RBAC	review an RBAC assignment	23
reachability	test service reachability	15
readiness	check readiness status	68
reboot	identify a pending reboot	41
recipient list	reconcile the recipient list	59
recovery	coordinate recovery communication	51
region	choose an approved region	32
release	coordinate a software release	59
remediation	assign remediation ownership	42
replica	compare replica behavior	69
reproduce	reproduce the export failure	6
reservation	compare reservation terms	33
resolution	confirm the resolution	6
resolver	identify the configured resolver	14
resource limit	inspect resource limits	69
resource request	review resource requests	69
response time	distinguish response time from repair time	6
restoration time	estimate restoration time cautiously	6
restore test	schedule a restore test	32
retention period	confirm the retention period	32
retry	schedule an authorized retry	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

right-sizing	assess right-sizing options	33
role	assign a reporting role	23
rollback	confirm rollback readiness	42
rollback plan	review the rollback plan	59
round-trip time	compare round-trip times	15
route	inspect the relevant route	14
routing	review routing evidence	14
RPO	agree on the RPO	33
RTO	agree on the RTO	33
saturation	investigate resource saturation	69
scope	establish the incident scope	5
scope assessment	conduct a scope assessment	51
separation of duties	preserve separation of duties	24
service	inspect the service endpoints	68
service account	identify the service-account owner	24
service desk	contact the service desk	5
service owner	notify the service owner	6
service request	fulfill a service request	5
session	review the account session	50
severity	review incident severity	51
sign-in log	preserve the sign-in log	50
snapshot	document a snapshot policy	32
SOC	notify the SOC	50
source of truth	name the source of truth	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

span identify a slow span	69
SSO troubleshoot an SSO session	24
stakeholder identify affected stakeholders	59
status update send a timed status update	6
subnet compare affected subnets	14
supersede supersede the earlier notice	60
supersedence check patch supersedence	42
symptom record the exact symptom	5
temporary access request temporary access	24
ticket update the ticket	5
timeline build an incident timeline	51
timeout record a connection timeout	15
TLS inspect a TLS handshake error	15
total cost compare like-for-like total cost	33
trace follow a distributed trace	69
triage triage an incident	5
TTL check a DNS record's TTL	14
urgency establish the urgency	5
user journey monitor the checkout user journey	69
validation record post-change validation	59
verification complete post-installation verification	41
virtual machine provision a virtual machine	32
VPN connect through the VPN	14
workaround verify a workaround	6

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] NIST. SP 800-61 Revision 3: Incident Response Recommendations and Considerations for Cybersecurity Risk Management (2025).

[Open the original source](#)

Background for incident coordination and accountable risk decisions. The fictional cases do not reproduce an operational response procedure. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Google SRE book. Monitoring Distributed Systems.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for symptoms versus causes, user-visible monitoring and constrained-capacity signals. No example incident or operating instruction is reproduced. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Kubernetes documentation. Liveness, Readiness, and Startup Probes.

[Open the original source](#)

Primary terminology for distinct probe purposes. A configured readiness check is not a universal test of user-visible transactions. Checked 10 October 2026.

[4] NIST SP 800-34 Rev. 1. Contingency Planning Guide for Federal Information Systems.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for recovery planning and testing terminology. The fictional service objectives are case facts, not requirements imposed by NIST on every organization. Checked 10 October 2026.

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Fictional workplace language practice, not instructions for administering real systems or handling live incidents. Follow authorized procedures, access controls, and qualified security review. Use invented accounts and records in practice.

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